

DOWNLOADABLE GUIDE



TAROT GUIDE

by

Tara

*Learn to read tarot from scratch,
step by step and at your own pace*

ALL 78 CARDS · SPREADS · PRACTICAL EXERCISES

taraoraculo.com

TARA'S TAROT GUIDE

A guide to learning to read tarot from scratch, step by step and at your own pace.



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Welcome

A letter from Tara to you

Hello, I'm Tara, and I'm so glad you're here.

If you're holding this guide, it's because something in you feels curious about the tarot. Perhaps its images call to you, perhaps someone once gave you a reading that stirred something deep inside, or perhaps you simply want a tool to listen to yourself better. Whatever your reason, it's the right one.

I've written these pages with you in mind: someone who is starting from scratch and wants to truly learn, without memorising endless lists or believing you need a special gift. Because let me tell you a secret: *reading the tarot can be learned*. Like a language. First you get to know the words, then the sentences and, one day, without noticing, you begin to hold a conversation.

In this guide you'll find everything you need for that journey:

- ✦ What the tarot is and how the deck is built.
- ✦ How to prepare your space, your cards and yourself before reading.
- ✦ The meaning of all 78 cards, upright and reversed, with advice for love and work.
- ✦ How to ask questions that truly open up paths.
- ✦ Three spreads explained step by step, from the simplest to the Celtic Cross.
- ✦ A method for linking the cards and telling the story they show you.
- ✦ A four-week practice plan to help you read with confidence.

A piece of advice before you begin: don't rush. Read calmly, keep your deck close and draw the cards as you read about them. Look at them, touch them, let them speak to you. The tarot isn't learned only with the head; it's also learned with the eyes and with the heart.

And always remember this: the cards don't decide for you. They show you a map, light up corners, ask you questions. The path is yours to choose.

With love,

Tara



What tarot is

History, structure and a way to understand it

♦ A LITTLE HISTORY

The first known tarot decks appeared in northern Italy in the 15th century. They were hand-painted cards made for noble families and used to play a game called *tarocchi*. Over the centuries, especially from the 18th century onwards in France, the tarot began to be used as a symbolic and divinatory tool.

In 1909 the Rider-Waite-Smith deck was published in England, illustrated by the artist Pamela Colman Smith. It was revolutionary because for the first time every card, the minor ones too, had scenes with people in them. Today it is the most widely used deck in the world and the basis of most modern decks. This guide follows its order and its tradition, so you'll be able to use it with almost any deck you choose.

What if my deck is a Marseille?

The Tarot de Marseille is older and its minor cards have no scenes, only the symbols of the suit. The meanings in this guide still work for you. The only practical difference is that in the Marseille Justice is Arcana VIII and Strength is XI, the other way round from Rider-Waite.

♦ HOW THE DECK IS MADE UP

A tarot deck has **78 cards**, divided into two large groups:

22 MAJOR ARCANA

Numbered from 0 to XXI. They represent life's great lessons, the deep forces and the moments that transform us. When they appear in a spread, the message carries weight.

56 MINOR ARCANA

Divided into four suits: Wands, Cups, Swords and Pentacles. They speak of everyday life: the situations, emotions, decisions and people around us.

The word *arcana* means "secret" or "mystery". Each card holds one, and learning the tarot is a matter of discovering them little by little.

♦ HOW THE TAROT WORKS

There are many ways of understanding the tarot, and you don't need to believe in anything in particular for it to be useful. I suggest you see it like this: **the tarot is a symbolic mirror**. Its images speak the language of archetypes, those universal figures we all carry inside: the mother, the sage, the rebel, the one who starts from zero.

When you ask a question and draw some cards, the images awaken associations, memories and intuitions in you that you may not have been looking at. The tarot doesn't give you answers from outside: it helps you find the ones you already sensed within and see your situation from another angle.

That's why a good reading doesn't leave you afraid or with a closed destiny. It leaves you with more clarity, more useful questions and more power over your decisions.

A responsible reading.

The tarot is a tool for reflection and entertainment. It never replaces the advice of a doctor, a psychologist, a lawyer or a financial adviser. If you're going through a difficult time, please also seek professional support and the support of the people who love you.



Before you begin

Your deck, your space and your first connection

♦ CHOOSING YOUR DECK

There's a belief that your first deck has to be a gift. It's lovely if it happens, but it isn't necessary: you can buy it yourself with all the intention in the world. What matters is that you enjoy looking at it. To begin with, I recommend a deck in the Rider-Waite tradition, with scenes on every card: it will help you enormously to remember the meanings, because the image itself tells you the story.

When choosing, look for three things: that the illustrations convey something to you, that the size of the cards is comfortable for your hands and that the style invites you to come back to it every day.

♦ GETTING TO KNOW YOUR CARDS

When you have your new deck, don't rush into reading straight away. Give yourself some time to get acquainted:

- ♦ Go through all the cards one by one, slowly, and look at each image for a few seconds.
- ♦ Separate the Major Arcana from the Minor and put them in order.
- ♦ Choose the card you're most drawn to and the one you like least. Write them in your journal: later on, they'll tell you a lot about yourself.
- ♦ Sleep with the deck nearby for a few days, for example on your bedside table. It's a simple way of making it your own.

♦ CARING FOR AND CLEANSING YOUR DECK

Many people feel that cards get "charged" with use or with other people's hands. Cleansing them from time to time is a small ritual that helps you start afresh with a clear mind. Choose the method that resonates most with you:

- ♦ **Putting them in order:** arrange all the cards in their original order, from The Fool to The World and from the Ace to the King of each suit.
- ♦ **Moonlight:** leave the deck by a window on a full-moon night.
- ♦ **A crystal:** place a clear quartz crystal or an amethyst on top of the deck for a few hours.

- ✦ **Your intention:** hold the deck in your hands, breathe deeply three times and picture a light running through it.

Keep it in a cloth bag or a box, in a quiet place. It isn't superstition: it's respect for a tool you're going to use to listen to yourself.

✦ SETTING THE MOMENT

Before reading, create a space that helps you concentrate. Nothing complicated is needed: a clear table, a pretty cloth to lay the cards on and, if you like, a lit candle. Silence your phone. Breathe.

The most important thing isn't the setting but your inner state. If you're very nervous, or desperately need a specific answer, it may not be the best moment. The tarot is read best from calm and curiosity.

✦ SHUFFLING AND CUTTING

Shuffle in whatever way feels comfortable: like ordinary cards, mixing them on the table or passing them from one hand to the other. While you shuffle, think about your question. When you feel it's enough, stop. There is no correct number of times.

Then cut the deck with your left hand (tradition says it's the hand of intuition) into three piles and put them back together in whatever order you like. Now you can draw your cards: from the top of the deck, or by fanning them out and choosing the ones that call to you.

✦ REVERSED CARDS, YES OR NO?

When you shuffle, some cards will end up upside down: these are the **reversed cards**. You can choose whether or not to use them.

- ✦ If you **don't use them**, simply turn the card round and read it upright. It's a perfectly valid option, especially at the beginning.
- ✦ If you **do use them**, they add nuance. A reversed card doesn't mean the opposite or something bad: it usually shows that this energy is blocked, delayed, lived inwardly or in excess.

My advice: start by reading only upright for the first few weeks. When you feel comfortable with the meanings, bring in the reversed cards. In this guide you have both meanings for every card.



The Major Arcana

The 22 great lessons of the Fool's journey

The 22 Major Arcana are the heart of the tarot. Each one represents a great lesson, a universal force or a stage on the path we all walk. When several appear in a spread, the situation is important: it isn't speaking of something passing, but of a deep process.

♦ THE FOOL'S JOURNEY

A beautiful way of understanding the Major Arcana is as a story. The protagonist is The Fool, card 0: a soul setting out on life's journey, light, curious and unafraid. With each card, The Fool meets a teacher or an experience that teaches something. This story is usually divided into three stages of seven cards:

I. THE OUTER WORLD

I TO VII

The Fool learns the rules of the world: discovers personal power (The Magician), intuition (The High Priestess), love and abundance (The Empress), structure (The Emperor), traditions (The Hierophant), the choices of the heart (The Lovers) and the will to move forward (The Chariot).

II. THE INNER WORLD

VIII TO XIV

Now The Fool looks within: finds a quiet strength (Strength), withdraws to listen (The Hermit), accepts cycles (Wheel of Fortune), takes on consequences (Justice), changes perspective (The Hanged Man), lets the old die away (Death) and finds balance (Temperance).

III. THE SPIRITUAL WORLD

XV TO XXI

Finally, The Fool faces their shadows (The Devil), lives through a great upheaval (The Tower) and is reborn with hope (The Star). They pass through their fears (The Moon), step into the light (The Sun), awaken to their purpose (Judgement) and, at last, complete the circle (The World).

When you study each card, remember where it sits on the journey. It will help you to understand it and to remember it.

How to read the card entries.

For each Major Arcanum you'll find its keywords, its main symbols, the upright and reversed meanings, what it says about love and work, a piece of advice and a question for your journal. Don't try to memorise everything: begin by holding on to the keywords and to the feeling the image gives you.



ARCANUM 0 · AIR

THE FOOL

The Fool is both the starting point and the traveller: the soul that doesn't know anything yet, and so dares to try everything. Each of the arcana that follow is a stop along the way.

UPRIGHT

new beginnings

freedom

trust

spontaneity

REVERSED

recklessness

fear of starting

scattered energy

SYMBOLS

A young man walks towards the edge of a cliff with his eyes on the sky. He carries a small bundle, because he barely needs any luggage, and a white rose, a sign of innocence. The little dog leaping at his side is the instinct that warns. The yellow sun behind him blesses the beginning.

UPRIGHT

When The Fool shows up in your reading, life is opening a door for you, and it isn't asking permission. This card is about starting before you have it all figured out, about taking the first step while the map is still blank. There's an almost childlike joy in it, a curiosity that won't be held back by what people might think. Maybe you're facing a trip, a change of direction or an idea that makes your heart flutter. The Fool reminds you that innocence isn't naivety: it's the ability to see the world with fresh eyes. You don't need to know where the road leads for it to be worth walking. Trust your intuition, travel light and leave room for surprise. The unknown can be a gift, too.

REVERSED

Reversed, The Fool can mean that the urge to leap is blocked: you want to start something, but fear has you frozen at the edge. It can also point to the opposite extreme, jumping in without looking where you land and mistaking freedom for running away. Ask yourself which of the two feels true for you. Sometimes the energy has turned inwards, and it's asking for a small inner adventure first, before the big leap out into the world.

♥ IN LOVE

In matters of the heart, it brings a breath of fresh air: an unexpected meeting, a relationship lived without a script, or the urge to be playful with your partner again. Open yourself to the new without losing sight of what you truly feel.

♦ AT WORK

It heralds projects being born, changes of direction and a desire to try unconventional paths. This is a good time to explore creative ideas, learn something different or give shape to that venture you've been dreaming about for a while. Start small, but start.

TARA'S ADVICE

Take that first step with an open heart, and let the road teach you the rest.

FOR YOUR JOURNAL

What would I start today if I weren't afraid of getting it wrong?



ARCANUM I · MERCURY

THE MAGICIAN

He is the first teacher the Fool meets: the Fool discovers that he has tools of his own and can turn his ideas into reality.

UPRIGHT

willpower

skill

manifestation

initiative

REVERSED

manipulation

untapped talent

self-doubt

SYMBOLS

The Magician raises a wand to the sky and points to the earth with his other hand: as above, so below. On his table lie a cup, a sword, a pentacle and a wand, the four elements. The infinity symbol floats above his head, and roses and lilies bloom at his feet.

UPRIGHT

The Magician looks you in the eye and tells you something very simple: you already have what you need. This card is pure energy in motion, the moment an intention becomes action. It speaks of focus, of talent, of knowing how to combine your resources to create something new. If you've been doubting your abilities, here's a clear answer. Your words, your emotions, your mind and your body make a powerful team when they pull in the same direction. The Magician also invites you to be aware of your influence: what you focus on grows. It's time to communicate clearly, to show what you can do and to take the reins. Don't wait for circumstances to be perfect. The magic happens when you decide to use what's on your table.

REVERSED

When he appears reversed, his energy may be asleep or misdirected. Maybe you have talent to spare but don't quite believe in it, so you leave it tucked away in a drawer. Or perhaps someone around you, or even you, is using charm and clever words to persuade rather than to build. Take an honest look at your intentions. This position asks you to reconnect with your gifts from a place of authenticity, not from the need to impress.

♥ IN LOVE

It favours taking the initiative: saying what you feel, making the first move or rekindling the spark with creative gestures. Remember that the loveliest kind of seduction comes from showing yourself as you are, with no tricks and no masks.

♦ AT WORK

This is an excellent card for pitching ideas, launching a project or showing what you can do. You have the resources; now it's about organising them with intention and communicating confidently what you bring to the table.

TARA'S ADVICE

Trust your gifts and use them today, even on something small: that's how all magic begins.

FOR YOUR JOURNAL

What talents are sitting on my table that I still haven't dared to use?



ARCANUM II · MOON

THE HIGH PRIESTESS

Having discovered the power to act, the Fool meets silent wisdom: he learns that not everything is won by doing, and that you also have to know how to listen.

UPRIGHT

intuition

mystery

stillness

inner wisdom

REVERSED

disconnection

secrets

mental noise

SYMBOLS

Seated between two pillars, one dark and one light, she guards the threshold between the seen and the hidden. She holds a half-concealed Torah scroll: not all knowledge is revealed at once. The moon at her feet speaks of cycles and emotions, and the veil of pomegranates protects the mysteries of life.

UPRIGHT

The High Priestess doesn't shout; she whispers. Her presence in your reading invites you to turn down the volume of the world and pay attention to that inner voice that knows more than you think. This is the card of intuition, of dreams that carry messages and of gut feelings worth taking seriously. You may be facing a situation that hasn't fully revealed itself yet; there's no need to force answers. Whatever needs to come to light will do so in its own time. In the meantime, observe, feel and trust your perception. This arcanum honours the receptive feminine that lives in all of us: the ability to welcome, to wait and to understand without having to put everything into words. Your wisdom is already there, waiting for you to listen.

REVERSED

Reversed, The High Priestess suggests that your intuition is there, but buried under too much noise: rushing, other people's opinions or the habit of second-guessing yourself. It can also reflect secrets that weigh on you or information being kept hidden. In other cases, it points to so much introspection that it cuts you off. Find a moment of real silence, with no screens, and ask yourself what you already know deep down but haven't allowed yourself to admit.

♥ IN LOVE

It speaks of deep connections and of what goes unsaid. There may be feelings being held back, yours or someone else's. Listen beyond the words, and give yourself time to understand what you really want before you act.

♦ AT WORK

It's time to observe before you move. Gather information, study, and trust your instincts to pick up on what others miss. Important decisions will turn out better if you let them ripen calmly and discreetly.

TARA'S ADVICE

Give yourself a moment of silence every day and listen to what your inner self has been wanting to tell you.

FOR YOUR JOURNAL

What is my intuition telling me about the situation that worries me most right now?



ARCANUM III · VENUS

THE EMPRESS

The Fool comes into contact with the abundance of nature and with nurturing love; he discovers that life, when it's cared for, blossoms.

UPRIGHT

abundance

creativity

nurturing

sensuality

REVERSED

self-neglect

creative block

smothering

SYMBOLS

Surrounded by a field of ripe wheat and a lush forest, the Empress reclines on soft cushions. Her crown of twelve stars links her to the cycles of the year. The shield bearing the symbol of Venus speaks of love and beauty, and the river flowing behind her is a reminder that life never stands still.

UPRIGHT

With The Empress comes spring, even if it's cold outside. This card celebrates everything that grows: projects, relationships, ideas and also your own capacity for enjoyment. It speaks of abundance as fullness, of surrounding yourself with beauty and tenderly caring for what you love. It's an invitation to reconnect with your body and your senses, to savour your food, to walk barefoot on the grass, to allow yourself pleasure without guilt. Creativity flows strongly under her influence, so make the most of it to give shape to what's inside you. And remember that the best way to nourish others starts with nourishing yourself. When you treat yourself with love, everything you touch blossoms a little more.

REVERSED

Reversed, The Empress usually means you're giving a lot outwards and very little inwards. You may feel you've lost touch with your creativity or your body, as if the well had run dry. In its excessive form, it speaks of caring so much that you smother, or of depending on other people's wellbeing in order to feel good yourself. This position doesn't signal scarcity; it signals the need to water your own garden again before you go back to tending everyone else's.

♥ IN LOVE

It brings warmth, affection and the desire to care for someone and let yourself be cared for. Relationships become more tender and sensual. If you're single, this is a good time to love yourself fiercely: that energy draws in connections that truly nourish you.

♦ AT WORK

It favours creative projects and anything that needs patience to bear fruit. What you sow now with dedication has a good chance of growing. Take care of your working environment, too: beauty inspires.

TARA'S ADVICE

Treat yourself today with the same tenderness you'd show someone you love deeply.

FOR YOUR JOURNAL

What am I growing in my life, and what does it need in order to flourish?



ARCANUM IV · ARIES

THE EMPEROR

After abundance, the Fool learns the value of structure: he discovers that dreams need boundaries, order and commitment to last over time.

UPRIGHT

structure

authority

stability

leadership

REVERSED

rigidity

control

lack of discipline

SYMBOLS

A mature man sits on a stone throne decorated with rams' heads, the sign of Aries and of initiative. He wears armour beneath his robe, ready to protect. In one hand he holds the ankh, emblem of life, and in the other an orb. Behind him rise barren mountains: steadiness and endurance.

UPRIGHT

The Emperor comes to bring order, and that can be a blessing. This card is about building solid foundations, setting up routines that hold you steady and owning your personal authority without apologising for it. It represents the part of you that can make decisions, set clear boundaries and stand up for what you value. Perhaps you need to plan, sort out your priorities or truly commit to a goal. It can also point to a protective figure or role model in your life. Its message isn't one of harshness but of responsibility: being the person who rules their own kingdom with fairness and integrity. Discipline, properly understood, isn't a cage. It's the framework that keeps your dreams standing when the wind blows.

REVERSED

When reversed, The Emperor's energy can spill over into rigidity, a need to control everything or heavy-handedness, whether it comes from you or from someone close. At the opposite extreme, it reveals a lack of structure: difficulty getting organised, setting boundaries or keeping your commitments. Notice which side of the scale you're on. This position asks you to find a more flexible inner authority, one that protects without oppressing and knows when to let go of the reins.

♥ IN LOVE

It points to relationships that are looking for stability and commitment. It's time to speak plainly about what you need and to make sure no one is imposing their will. Emotional security is built on mutual respect and honest agreements.

♦ AT WORK

It favours planning, management and leadership. It may signal new responsibilities or the need to put processes in order. Give your ideas some structure: a clear plan will help your projects move forward with a steady step.

TARA'S ADVICE

Build a small habit today that supports your dreams, and protect it with love and firmness.

FOR YOUR JOURNAL

Where do I need to set a clear boundary to protect what matters to me?



ARCANUM V · TAURUS

THE HIEROPHANT

The Fool enters the school of life: he learns about the traditions, the teachers and the shared values that others pass on to him before he finds his own.

UPRIGHT

tradition

teaching

values

belonging

REVERSED

dogmatism

rebellion

social pressure

SYMBOLS

The High Priest sits between two pillars, blessing with a raised hand. He wears a triple crown, a sign of spiritual authority. At his feet, two crossed keys open the door between the conscious and the unconscious. Two disciples kneel before him, ready to learn what tradition has to offer.

UPRIGHT

The Hierophant speaks of shared learning and the roots that hold you up. It represents the teachings handed down from generation to generation, institutions, rituals and the groups you belong to. It may suggest that you'd benefit from seeking guidance from someone experienced, signing up for a course or getting closer to a community that shares your values. It also invites you to reflect on your beliefs: where do they come from, and do they still make sense to you? This card doesn't ask for blind obedience, but for understanding. Knowing the rules well lets you choose consciously which ones you want to honour. Sometimes the well-trodden path is exactly what you need, because it offers structure, meaning and the relief of not having to invent everything from scratch.

REVERSED

Reversed, The Hierophant questions the rules. It may reflect that you feel constrained by the expectations of your family, society or a group, and that you need to do things your own way. On its more stuck side, it speaks of following rules you no longer feel are yours, simply out of habit or fear of rejection. This position encourages you to seek your own spiritual truth and become your own guide, without dismissing what you've learned.

♥ IN LOVE

It often speaks of commitment, shared values and relationships that follow traditional paths. It's a good time to ask each other what you believe in and what you want to build together, and whether those promises come from the heart or from habit.

♦ AT WORK

It favours training, mentoring and environments with clear rules. Learning from someone experienced or following proven methods will help you. If you work in a team, cooperation and respect for agreements will be key.

TARA'S ADVICE

Look for teachers who inspire you, but remember that you have the final say over your own life.

FOR YOUR JOURNAL

Which inherited beliefs am I still holding on to, and which ones truly feel like mine?



ARCANUM VI · GEMINI

THE LOVERS

The Fool faces his first great choice: he discovers love and, with it, the need to decide according to his own values.

UPRIGHT

love

choice

union

alignment

REVERSED

indecision

imbalance

inconsistency

SYMBOLS

A naked man and woman gaze at each other under the blessing of an angel, who represents higher guidance. Behind her stands the tree of knowledge with the serpent; behind him, a tree of flames. Their nakedness speaks of authenticity, and the mountain in the distance of the path that opens up after an honest decision.

UPRIGHT

Although its name immediately brings romance to mind, The Lovers is above all about choices that come from the heart. This card appears when you're facing an important decision that defines who you are and where you want to go. It asks you to bring what you think, what you feel and what you do into alignment. Of course, it also celebrates love: deep attraction, closeness, meeting someone who mirrors you. But its deepest message is integrity. When you choose from your true values, rather than being swayed only by convenience or fear, everything falls into place in an almost magical way. Ask yourself which option brings you closer to your truth. The right answer is usually the one that lets you keep looking at yourself in the mirror with kindness.

REVERSED

Reversed, this card can point to difficulty deciding, endlessly going round in circles over your options. It can also reflect imbalances in a relationship, where one person gives far more than the other, or a gap between what you say you want and what you actually do. Sometimes the energy has turned inwards and the conflict is with yourself: two parts of you pulling in opposite directions. Listen to both before you choose.

♥ IN LOVE

One of the most beautiful cards for love: connection, attraction and harmony. It may also ask you to make a clear choice about a relationship. Choose from what you truly feel, not from what's expected of you.

♦ AT WORK

It may point to a promising partnership or the need to choose between two career paths. Weigh up which option fits best with your values and with the person you want to become, not just with what's comfortable.

TARA'S ADVICE

Choose what makes your heart smile and, at the same time, lets your conscience rest easy.

FOR YOUR JOURNAL

What decision have I been putting off, and what would my heart tell me if I let it speak?



ARCANUM VII · CANCER

THE CHARIOT

Having made his choice, the Fool sets off: he learns to steer opposing forces with determination and wins his first great victory.

UPRIGHT

determination

progress

victory

self-control

REVERSED

lack of direction

feeling stuck

impatience

SYMBOLS

A young warrior drives a chariot drawn by two sphinxes, one white and one black, pulling in different directions: he steers without reins, by willpower alone. His armour bears crescent moons, and a canopy of stars covers him. The city lies behind him: he has set out to conquer his own path.

UPRIGHT

The Chariot is movement with direction. When it comes up in your reading, it tells you that you can move forward, as long as you're clear about where you're going. This card celebrates willpower, discipline and confidence in your abilities. It's about overcoming obstacles, not because they disappear, but because you learn how to handle them. The two sphinxes represent opposing drives within you, like reason and emotion, or desire and fear. The point isn't to get rid of them, but to have them work together under your command. If you're fighting for a goal, The Chariot tells you that your efforts are paying off and the finish line is closer than you think. Stay focused, take a deep breath and keep going. You're holding the reins, even if no one can see them.

REVERSED

Reversed, The Chariot can mean you feel stuck, or that you're heading in lots of directions at once without getting anywhere. There may be impatience, frustration or the feeling that outside forces are dragging you along. At other times, it points to too much control: wanting to win at all costs, even if it costs you your peace. Stop for a moment, redefine your goal and check whether it's truly yours before you speed up again.

♥ IN LOVE

It asks for clarity about what you want and the courage to go after it. In a relationship, it can speak of overcoming a challenge together or moving into a new stage. Make sure the urge to lead doesn't leave the other person without a voice.

♦ AT WORK

Very favourable for reaching goals, getting ahead of the competition or seeing a demanding project through. Your persistence makes the difference. Organise your energy, avoid spreading yourself thin and celebrate every step forward, however small.

TARA'S ADVICE

Decide where you want to go and move forward with a steady step, even if the road has a few bends.

FOR YOUR JOURNAL

What opposing forces live inside me, and how could they work together in my favour?



ARCANUM VIII · LEO

STRENGTH

The Fool discovers that true strength doesn't lie in dominating others, but in patiently embracing his own instincts.

UPRIGHT

courage

compassion

patience

inner strength

REVERSED

insecurity

impulsiveness

being too hard on yourself

SYMBOLS

A woman dressed in white gently closes a lion's jaws, with no apparent effort. The lion embodies passions and instincts; she, the serenity that tames them. A garland of flowers encircles her, and the infinity symbol shines above her head, as with The Magician: her power is spiritual.

UPRIGHT

There's a kind of strength that makes no noise, and that's exactly what this card is about. Strength appears to remind you that you're capable of far more than you imagine, not through toughness, but through tenderness. It represents the courage to face your fears, your anger or your impulses without suppressing them or letting them rule you. Like the woman stroking the lion, you can meet your intense emotions with patience and kindness until they become allies. This arcanum also speaks of resilience: of standing tall with dignity in the face of difficulty. If you're going through a demanding time, trust your inner steadiness. Your real strength comes from calm, from compassion towards yourself and others, and from knowing you don't need to prove anything to anyone.

REVERSED

Reversed, Strength suggests that your self-confidence has been shaken. Maybe you feel small in the face of a challenge, or you doubt your abilities. In other cases, the lion has got loose: impulsive reactions, anger that flares up or high standards that turn harsh on you. The energy is there, but it's blocked or poorly channelled. Go back to basics: breathe, speak to yourself kindly and remember all the times you've already pulled through.

♥ IN LOVE

It speaks of patient love, the kind that knows how to wait and understand. It helps ease tension with gentleness rather than pride. It also reminds you that shared vulnerability is a beautiful form of courage.

♦ AT WORK

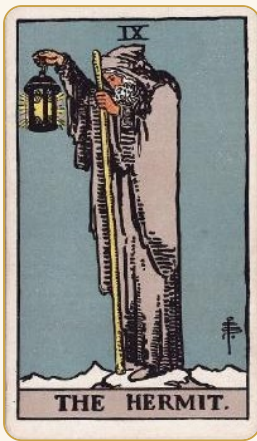
It shows you have the composure needed to handle difficult situations or tricky people. Your ability to stay calm gives you natural authority. Persevere: quiet consistency will take you far.

TARA'S ADVICE

Hold your most intense emotions with kindness, the way you'd soothe a frightened animal.

FOR YOUR JOURNAL

Which of my emotions needs to be soothed rather than suppressed?



ARCANUM IX · VIRGO

THE HERMIT

The Fool steps away from the noise of the world and sets out on the journey inwards, seeking his own light in chosen solitude.

UPRIGHT

introspection

chosen solitude

searching

inner guidance

REVERSED

isolation

avoidance

fear of looking within

SYMBOLS

An old man in a grey robe stands on the summit of a snowy mountain. He holds a lantern with a six-pointed star shining inside: the wisdom that lights only the next step. His staff supports him and reminds him that the path is walked slowly. The summit speaks of inner achievements.

UPRIGHT

The Hermit invites you to pause. It isn't running away, but a conscious retreat so you can hear yourself without interference. This card appears when you need space to reflect, sort out your thoughts and reconnect with what really matters to you. You may be looking for answers no one else can give you, and that's okay. Sometimes clarity only comes in silence, on an unhurried walk or while writing in your journal by candlelight. His lantern doesn't light the whole path, only the next step, and that's enough. The Hermit can also point to a wise mentor, or to your own ability to guide others through your experience. Enjoy your own company. In it you'll find treasures that all the bustle keeps you from seeing.

REVERSED

When reversed, retreat may have turned into isolation. Perhaps you've shut yourself away too much and you miss contact with others, even if it's hard to admit. Or the opposite: you fill your schedule so you never have to be alone with your thoughts. Both situations hide something that's asking to be looked at. This position encourages you to find a healthy balance between your inner world and other people, and to let others walk beside you without losing your centre.

♥ IN LOVE

It may point to a period of chosen solitude to get to know yourself better, or the need for space within a relationship. That time alone doesn't push you apart: it helps you return to the relationship with more clarity about what you need.

♦ AT WORK

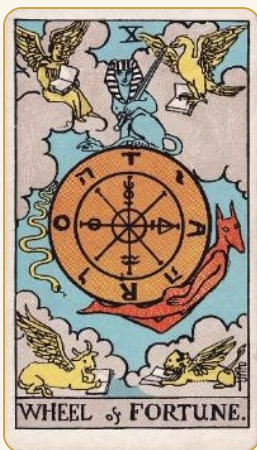
It favours study, research and focused work. It's a good time to rethink your calling and ask yourself what meaning your work holds for you. Seek advice from someone experienced if you need it.

TARA'S ADVICE

Switch off the noise for a while and walk with yourself, patiently, by the light of your own lantern.

FOR YOUR JOURNAL

What answer am I searching for out there that I can really only find within?



ARCANUM X · JUPITER

WHEEL OF FORTUNE

Emerging from his retreat, the Fool understands that life moves in cycles and that there are forces greater than himself that he must learn to flow with.

UPRIGHT

cycles

change

opportunity

destiny

REVERSED

resisting change

stagnation

repeating patterns

SYMBOLS

A great wheel turns in the sky, marked with letters and alchemical symbols. A sphinx sits on top, a sign of balance; a serpent descends and an Anubis figure rises, like life's ups and downs. In the corners, four winged creatures read books: the elements, and stability within movement.

UPRIGHT

Everything turns, and the Wheel of Fortune reminds you of this with a smile. This card announces a change of cycle, a moment when circumstances start to move, often in your favour. It can bring unexpected opportunities, meaningful coincidences or the feeling that, at last, something is getting unstuck. Its lesson is twofold. On the one hand, ride the current while it's flowing your way. On the other, remember that nothing is permanent: neither the hard times nor the good ones. That shouldn't frighten you; it should set you free. You don't control the wheel, but you do control how you move with it. Notice the patterns that repeat in your life; they hold valuable lessons. When you understand the cycle, you stop feeling like a victim of chance and start dancing with it.

REVERSED

Reversed, the Wheel can speak of resistance to a change that's already under way: clinging to the familiar even though it no longer serves you. It can also reflect the feeling of being stuck in a loop, living through similar situations over and over again. It isn't bad luck, but an invitation to look at which of your own patterns keeps repeating. When you change the way you respond, the wheel changes direction too. Start with one different gesture.

♥ IN LOVE

It points to turning points in your love life: meetings that feel like destiny, or a relationship entering a new phase. Let yourself be surprised, and notice which emotional patterns keep repeating so you can transform them.

♦ AT WORK

Opportunities or unexpected changes may come up. Stay alert to what's shifting around you and be flexible. A stalled project could come back to life if you seize the moment quickly.

TARA'S ADVICE

Flow with change instead of resisting it: the wheel turns, and you can learn to dance with it.

FOR YOUR JOURNAL

What pattern keeps repeating in my life, and what is it trying to teach me?



ARCANUM XI · LIBRA

JUSTICE

Halfway through his journey, the Fool stops to look back at his actions: he learns that every decision has consequences and that truth is his best compass.

UPRIGHT

balance

truth

responsibility

cause and effect

REVERSED

self-deception

imbalance

guilt

SYMBOLS

A figure seated between two pillars holds a pair of scales in the left hand and a double-edged sword in the right. The scales weigh impartially; the sword cuts through what's false and shows that truth has two sides. The direct gaze asks for honesty, and the purple veil suggests compassion and wisdom.

UPRIGHT

Justice asks you to look at yourself honestly and without drama. This card speaks of balance, of taking responsibility for your choices and of understanding that what you sow eventually comes back to you. It isn't an outside verdict or a punishment; it's the clarity that arrives when you stop fooling yourself. It may appear when you have an important decision to make and need to weigh up the pros and cons with a cool head. It also suggests that a situation is moving towards a fair resolution, especially if you've acted with integrity. Ask yourself what is fair, not only for others, but for you too. Sometimes the fairest decision is to stop giving yourself less than you deserve. Speak sincerely, act consistently and trust that the truth puts everything in its proper place.

REVERSED

Reversed, Justice can point to an imbalance: giving more than you receive, or feeling that something isn't fair. It can also speak of avoiding your share of responsibility or, on the contrary, carrying blame that isn't yours. It's an invitation to take an honest look at the scales. Owning your part without punishing yourself, and letting go of what isn't yours, brings back your peace. Justice begins with how you treat yourself.

♥ IN LOVE

It calls for balanced relationships, where both people give and receive. It's time for honest conversations and for checking whether your agreements are fair. Honesty, even when it's hard, builds stronger bonds.

♦ AT WORK

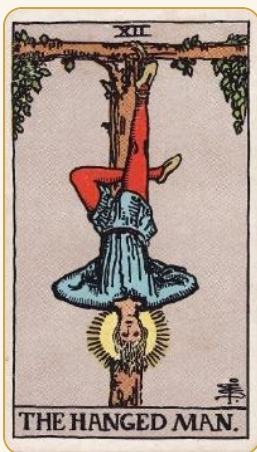
It favours well-considered decisions, transparency and clear agreements. Read carefully whatever you sign and act with integrity. Your honest effort tends to be recognised once things are seen in perspective.

TARA'S ADVICE

Look at your situation through honest eyes and choose what you can stand behind with a clear conscience.

FOR YOUR JOURNAL

In which part of my life are the scales tipped, and what can I do to rebalance them?



ARCANUM XII · WATER

THE HANGED MAN

The Fool comes to a complete stop and surrenders: he discovers that sometimes the deepest understanding comes when you stop fighting and look at the world upside down.

UPRIGHT

pause

new perspective

surrender

patience

REVERSED

stagnation

resistance

pointless sacrifice

SYMBOLS

A man hangs upside down from a living tree, tied by one foot, with his other leg crossed. His face is serene and a halo of light surrounds his head: he isn't suffering, he's understanding. The tau-shaped tree speaks of life and growth. His hands behind his back show a willing surrender.

UPRIGHT

The Hanged Man asks you for something many people find hard: to stop. You may feel that things aren't moving, that you're in limbo. This card tells you that the pause has a purpose. It isn't the time to force things, but to look from a different angle. When you stop pushing, solutions appear that you couldn't see before. This arcanum is about letting go of control, accepting what isn't up to you and finding peace in the waiting. It may also ask you to give up something small to gain something more valuable in the long run. Look at the hanged man's calm face: he isn't trapped, he's meditating. Try looking at your situation upside down. What seemed like a problem may turn out to be an opportunity in disguise. Sometimes enlightenment arrives head first.

REVERSED

Reversed, The Hanged Man can mean that the pause has turned into stagnation: you keep putting off decisions, waiting for a perfect moment that never comes. It can also reflect a reluctance to let go, clinging to a way of seeing things that no longer works, or sacrificing yourself for others when no one has asked you to. Ask yourself whether you're waiting with purpose or simply avoiding moving. If it's the latter, one small gesture is enough to break the inertia and get things moving again.

♥ IN LOVE

It invites you to pause and look at the relationship from another perspective. Perhaps this isn't the moment to decide, but to understand. Avoid sacrificing too much: healthy love doesn't require you to forget yourself.

♦ AT WORK

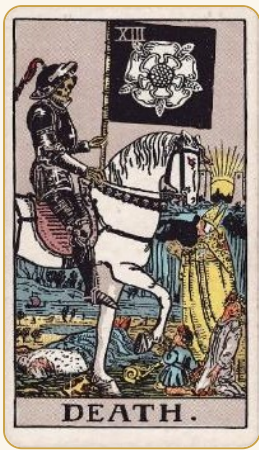
A project may be on hold or moving more slowly than you'd like. Use this time to rethink your approach, learn or come up with new ideas. Creative solutions appear when you change your point of view.

TARA'S ADVICE

Let go of the need to control, and try looking at your situation from a completely new angle.

FOR YOUR JOURNAL

What would I see differently if I allowed myself to look at my problem upside down?



ARCANUM XIII · SCORPIO

DEATH

The Fool goes through his great transformation: he lets one version of himself die so that something more authentic can be born.

UPRIGHT

transformation

necessary endings

renewal

letting go

REVERSED

resisting change

attachment

fear of letting go

SYMBOLS

An armoured skeleton rides a white horse, carrying a black banner with a white rose: life being reborn. Figures from every walk of life bow before him, because change comes to everyone. In the background, between two towers, the sun is rising: after every ending, a new beginning dawns.

UPRIGHT

Take a deep breath: this card isn't about physical death. Death is one of the most misunderstood arcana and, in reality, one of the most liberating. It represents deep transformation, the necessary endings that make way for the new. Something in your life has come full circle, whether it's a stage, a relationship, a habit or a way of seeing yourself. Letting it go may hurt, but it's also what allows something more authentic to be born. Like autumn stripping the trees before spring, this ending is a natural part of life. Don't fight the change that's already happening; walk alongside it with respect. Honour what was, give thanks for what it taught you and open your hands. Behind this door, a freer version of you is waiting.

REVERSED

Reversed, Death usually points to resistance to an ending you can already sense. Maybe you're clinging to something out of fear of the unknown, even though you know it's no longer good for you. That resistance drags the process out and makes it heavier. It can also point to a slow inner transformation, one that happens on the inside before it shows on the outside. Ask yourself what you're holding on to purely out of habit, and what you'd gain if you let it go. Letting go isn't losing: it's making room.

♥ IN LOVE

It speaks of transformation: a relationship that renews itself completely, or a chapter in your love life that closes to make way for something healthier. Say a grateful goodbye to what no longer fits, and make room for the new.

♦ AT WORK

It points to the close of a stage in your working life or the need to reinvent yourself. It may be the end of a project or of a way of working. What ends leaves room for opportunities that are more in tune with who you are.

TARA'S ADVICE

Let go gratefully of what has run its course, and trust the space that opens up.

FOR YOUR JOURNAL

Which part of my life is asking to end so that something new can be born?



ARCANUM XIV · SAGITTARIUS

TEMPERANCE

After the transformation, the Fool learns to bring opposites together calmly: he discovers the art of the right measure and of patient healing.

UPRIGHT

balance

harmony

moderation

integration

REVERSED

excess

impatience

imbalance

SYMBOLS

An angel with one foot in the water and the other on land pours liquid from one cup into another, blending without spilling a drop: the art of combining the emotional and the material. A triangle on the chest speaks of spirit. A path leads towards a shining crown on the horizon, and irises bloom beside the pool.

UPRIGHT

Temperance arrives like a soothing balm. After intense times, this card brings you calm, balance and the feeling that everything is starting to find its place. It speaks of the wisdom of the right measure: not too much and not too little. It invites you to patiently blend the different parts of your life, like work and rest, reason and emotion, or what you give and what you receive, until you find your own recipe for harmony. It's a card of emotional healing and reconciliation, with yourself and with others. There's no rush: important processes need their time, like a good stew on a low heat. Trust the natural rhythm of things. When you act from a place of calm, your decisions are wiser and your energy flows without wearing you out.

REVERSED

Reversed, Temperance warns that something is out of balance: perhaps you're working too much, not looking after yourself, or swinging from one extreme to the other without finding the middle ground. It can also reflect impatience, wanting instant results from processes that need time. This position encourages you to look at where you've lost your sense of proportion and make small adjustments. You don't need to change everything; it's enough to start blending again with care, like tweaking a recipe until it tastes right.

♥ IN LOVE

It brings harmony and mutual understanding. Relationships benefit from patience, listening and a willingness to meet each other halfway. It's a beautiful card for healing wounds and reconciling different points of view.

♦ AT WORK

It favours cooperation, negotiation and a healthy balance between your personal and working life. Move forward at a sustainable pace. Combining different skills or collaborating with very different people can bring surprising results.

TARA'S ADVICE

Look for your middle ground today and move forward calmly: what simmers slowly tastes better.

FOR YOUR JOURNAL

In which area of my life have I lost my balance, and what small adjustment could help?



ARCANUM XV · CAPRICORN

THE DEVIL

The Fool meets his shadow: he discovers the chains he himself has accepted and begins to understand that he can take them off.

UPRIGHT

attachments

desire

shadow

patterns

REVERSED

release

awareness

relapse

SYMBOLS

A horned figure with bat wings presides over the scene from a pedestal, holding a downturned torch. At his feet stand a chained man and woman; yet the chains hang loosely around their necks and they could take them off. The inverted star on his forehead speaks of matter eclipsing spirit.

UPRIGHT

Don't let the way he looks scare you: The Devil isn't about evil, but about attachments. This card brings to light whatever binds you, like habits, dependencies, relationships that drain you, fears or the chase after instant gratification that leaves you empty afterwards. It's the shadow, that part of you you'd rather not see but which, when you look at it honestly, loses much of its power. Notice the most important detail in the image: the chains are loose. No one is holding you there by force; often it's habit, comfort or fear that keeps you in place. The Devil also recognises desire and pleasure as legitimate parts of life, as long as you're the one doing the choosing. Ask yourself what controls you. Naming it is the first step towards freedom.

REVERSED

Reversed, The Devil usually brings good news: you're starting to realise what was holding you back and taking steps to free yourself. It may mark the moment to break with a habit or a dynamic you no longer want to keep up. It can also warn of a relapse, or of the temptation to go back to what's familiar. Be patient with yourself: loosening chains takes time, and every small act of freedom counts. Celebrate your progress, however modest it seems.

♥ IN LOVE

It can speak of intense passion, but also of emotional dependency, jealousy or relationships where someone loses their freedom. Ask yourself whether the relationship helps you grow or ties you down. Healthy love doesn't chain anyone.

♦ AT WORK

It points to situations where you feel trapped by routine, pressure or fear of change. Take a look at what's really keeping you there. Recognising those ties gives you back the power to decide your next move.

TARA'S ADVICE

Face whatever binds you head-on, and remember that the key to set yourself free is in your hands.

FOR YOUR JOURNAL

Which habit or relationship is taking away my freedom, and why do I keep holding on to it?



ARCANUM XVI · MARS

THE TOWER

The false structures the Fool had built come crashing down all at once, and among the rubble he finally finds the truth that sets him free.

UPRIGHT

sudden change

revelation

liberation

awakening

REVERSED

fear of change

inner crisis

avoiding the inevitable

SYMBOLS

A bolt of lightning strikes the top of a tall tower and knocks off its crown. Two figures fall through the air amid flames. The tower symbolises structures built on false foundations; the lightning, the sudden truth that illuminates. The drops of light falling down are a reminder that, even in the upheaval, there's a divine spark.

UPRIGHT

The Tower is the earthquake card, and yes, it can be unsettling. But its message is profoundly liberating. It represents a sudden change that brings down whatever was resting on shaky foundations: beliefs, plans or situations that, deep down, were no longer true. Sometimes life doesn't wait until you feel ready to change; it gives you a push. It might be an unexpected revelation, a conversation that changes everything or a realisation there's no going back from. Even if the moment feels intense, what falls away makes room to build something more authentic. Think of the lightning as a light that suddenly reveals what was hidden. After the shake-up comes enormous clarity. What truly belongs to you will remain; the rest was really just weighing you down.

REVERSED

Reversed, The Tower may mean the change is happening on the inside: a quiet crisis of belief or a private awakening. It can also reflect an attempt to avoid something that's already wobbling, putting off a collapse that, deep down, you know is necessary. Resisting usually prolongs the discomfort. This position invites you to let go little by little, by your own choice, before life asks you to do it all at once. A change you choose is always gentler.

♥ IN LOVE

It can bring revelations or shake-ups that put a relationship to the test. What isn't genuine tends to fall away, and what's real comes out stronger. It's a time for complete honesty, with yourself and with the other person.

♦ AT WORK

It points to unexpected changes that upend plans or structures. Unsettling as it may be, it can be the chance to rethink what wasn't working. Stay calm, notice what comes to light and rebuild on firmer foundations.

TARA'S ADVICE

Let what can't stand fall away, and trust that after the storm you'll have more room to be yourself.

FOR YOUR JOURNAL

Which structure in my life do I know, deep down, is running out of foundations?



ARCANUM XVII · AQUARIUS

THE STAR

After the storm of The Tower, the Fool finds hope again: he feels guided once more and begins to heal under a clear sky.

UPRIGHT

hope

healing

inspiration

faith

REVERSED

discouragement

disconnection

lack of faith in yourself

SYMBOLS

A naked woman kneeling by a pool pours water from two jugs: one onto the water and the other onto the land, nourishing both emotion and matter. Above her shines a great star surrounded by seven smaller ones. A bird perches in a tree, a messenger of the soul. Her nakedness expresses authenticity and vulnerability.

UPRIGHT

After the storm, the sky clears and The Star appears. Few cards carry so much peace. This arcanum brings you renewed hope, the quiet certainty that the worst is behind you and that there's light on your path. It's time to heal, to rest your soul and to trust yourself and life again. It invites you to show yourself as you are, without masks, because your authenticity is your greatest gift. The Star also awakens inspiration: dreams that feel possible again, creative ideas and a renewed sense of purpose. Its energy is gentle rather than dazzling, like the steady glow that guides sailors through the night. Let it remind you that you deserve good things. Make a wish, tend your faith and move calmly towards what you long for.

REVERSED

Reversed, The Star suggests that your light is still there, even if it's hard to see right now. It may reflect discouragement, emotional exhaustion or a loss of faith in your dreams after a difficult period. Sometimes the energy has turned inwards and you need to reconnect with it on your own before sharing it. Look for small sources of inspiration, surround yourself with what comforts you and remember that hope can be cultivated too, like a seed that needs water and patience.

♥ IN LOVE

A beautiful card for love: healing old wounds, tenderness and sincere connection. Open your heart little by little. If you're in a relationship, it's a good time to renew the dreams you share.

♦ AT WORK

It brings inspiration and renewal. It's ideal for picking up career dreams again, starting creative projects or finding your motivation once more. Trust your long-term vision, even if the path is still quiet for now.

TARA'S ADVICE

Believe in your dreams again, and let your light shine without asking permission.

FOR YOUR JOURNAL

Which dream have I let fade, and what do I need to light it up again?



ARCANUM XVIII · PISCES

THE MOON

Guided by hope, the Fool ventures into the night of the unconscious, where he must make his way through his fears and illusions by trusting his intuition.

UPRIGHT

intuition

dreams

uncertainty

the unconscious

REVERSED

confusion clearing

fears fading

self-deception

SYMBOLS

A moon with a face shines between two towers. A dog and a wolf howl at it: the tame and the wild within us. A crayfish crawls out of the water, like the contents of the unconscious rising to the surface. A path winds between them towards the mountains: the uncertain road travelled by night.

UPRIGHT

The Moon takes you into a realm of soft shadows and deceptive reflections. When it appears, not everything is as it seems, and it's okay not to have all the answers. This card speaks of the deep emotional world, of dreams, of imagination and of the fears that sometimes distort reality. You may feel overwhelmed by confusion or doubt, like someone walking an unfamiliar path at night. The key is not to give in to panic or fantasy, but to trust your intuition, which can see in the dark. Pay attention to your dreams and to subtle sensations: they carry valuable messages. The Moon also awakens creativity and sensitivity. Go slowly, with no rush to decide. In time, the fog lifts and the truth reveals itself.

REVERSED

Reversed, The Moon usually means the fog is beginning to lift: you understand something that used to confuse you, or a fear loses its grip. It can also point to ignoring your emotions or your intuition, or telling yourself stories that aren't true so you don't have to face something. Ask yourself which part of what you fear is real and which part is the work of your imagination. Clarity comes when you look at your shadows bravely and give them a name.

♥ IN LOVE

There may be doubts, insecurities or things left unsaid. Avoid jumping to conclusions and trust what you truly feel. Honest conversations help chase away ghosts and misunderstandings that only exist in the imagination.

♦ AT WORK

It points to a period of uncertainty or incomplete information. Don't make important decisions without clearing up the details. Use this lunar energy for creative and intuitive projects, where imagination is an advantage.

TARA'S ADVICE

Walk slowly in the dark, and let your intuition be your torch.

FOR YOUR JOURNAL

What fear is distorting the way I see the situation I'm in?



ARCANUM XIX · SUN

THE SUN

Having made it through the night, the Fool steps out into full daylight: he reconnects with his inner child and celebrates the simple joy of being alive.

UPRIGHT

joy

success

vitality

clarity

REVERSED

dimmed joy

overoptimism

delays

SYMBOLS

A radiant sun with a human face presides over a clear sky. Beneath it, a naked child rides a horse with arms flung wide and a red banner: innocence, freedom and enthusiasm. Behind a wall grow sunflowers that turn towards him, just as we do when we seek the light. Everything in the image breathes confidence.

UPRIGHT

What a joy to see The Sun in a reading! It's one of the brightest cards in the tarot, bringing optimism, clarity and success. Everything that was in shadow is lit up: you understand what's happening to you better and you feel energised to move forward. This arcanum speaks of simple happiness, the kind that comes from being at peace with yourself and enjoying the little things. It invites you to reconnect with your inner child, to play, to laugh and to show yourself without fear. It also heralds achievements, recognition and warm relationships. Its message is clear: you're allowed to shine, and you don't have to hide your light to make others comfortable. Enjoy this moment with gratitude. Share your warmth with the people around you, because joy, when it's shared, multiplies.

REVERSED

Reversed, The Sun doesn't lose its light, but it may be hidden behind passing clouds. Maybe you're finding it hard to enjoy the good things you have, or a success is arriving a little later than expected. It can also speak of an overoptimism that overlooks the details. At other times, the joy has turned inwards and you need to nurture it privately first. Look for small moments of light every day; your glow is still there, waiting for you to notice it again.

♥ IN LOVE

Excellent for love: happy relationships, closeness, honesty and the desire to share. It's a time to enjoy each other and show your affection openly. If you're single, your natural glow draws attention without you having to go looking for it.

♦ AT WORK

It heralds success, recognition and projects that take off. Your enthusiasm is contagious. It's a good time to show your work, lead with optimism and celebrate achievements, both yours and the team's.

TARA'S ADVICE

Allow yourself to shine today without holding back, and celebrate all the good in your life.

FOR YOUR JOURNAL

What makes me feel truly alive, and how much room do I give it in my everyday life?



ARCANUM XX · FIRE

JUDGEMENT

The Fool hears an inner call that wakes him: he looks back over his whole journey, forgives himself and is reborn with a clearer purpose.

UPRIGHT

awakening

inner calling

rebirth

forgiveness

REVERSED

self-criticism

doubt

ignoring the call

SYMBOLS

An angel, traditionally Gabriel, blows a trumpet hung with a flag bearing a cross. Below, naked figures rise from their coffins with open arms, answering the call. The mountains in the background and the water speak of a deep awakening: leaving the old behind and being reborn with awareness.

UPRIGHT

Judgement sounds like a trumpet waking you up. This card heralds a moment of deep clarity, when you look at your life with perspective and understand the meaning of what you've lived through. It isn't a judgement that punishes, but a rebirth: the chance to leave old guilt behind, forgive yourself and start again with greater awareness. You may feel an inner calling, a vocation or a desire to live in a way that's more in tune with who you are today. This arcanum asks you to answer that voice. It also speaks of important decisions made from maturity rather than fear. Look back on your story with compassion: every experience has brought you here. Now you can get up, dust yourself off and walk towards a fuller, more authentic version of yourself.

REVERSED

Reversed, Judgement can mean that you hear the call but hesitate to answer, out of fear or because you don't feel ready. It can also reflect excessive self-criticism that keeps you from moving forward, or difficulty forgiving yourself for past mistakes. This position encourages you to be kinder to yourself. You don't need to be perfect to be reborn; all it takes is giving yourself permission to start again, with who you are today.

♥ IN LOVE

It speaks of second chances, reconciliations or seeing a relationship with new eyes. It's a time to forgive, let go of resentment and decide with maturity what you want to be part of your love life.

♦ AT WORK

It may point to a calling, a change of career direction or taking stock of a work cycle. Listen to what truly motivates you. It's a good time to reinvent yourself and go for what you're passionate about.

TARA'S ADVICE

Listen to the voice calling you to be yourself, and answer it with courage and compassion.

FOR YOUR JOURNAL

What inner calling have I been hearing for a while that I still haven't dared to answer?



ARCANUM XXI · SATURN

THE WORLD

The Fool completes his journey: he brings together everything he has learned, feels in harmony with the universe and is ready to begin a new cycle, wiser than before.

UPRIGHT

fulfilment

achievement

integration

completion

REVERSED

unfinished cycle

lack of closure

stagnation

SYMBOLS

A dancing figure wrapped in violet cloth floats inside an oval laurel wreath, a symbol of victory and fulfilment. She holds a wand in each hand, balancing forces. In the corners appear the angel, the eagle, the bull and the lion: the four elements brought together in harmony.

UPRIGHT

The World is the culmination of the journey, and its appearance is cause for celebration. This card speaks of fulfilment, of having completed an important stage and of feeling in harmony with yourself and your surroundings. Everything you've lived through, the good and the difficult, takes on meaning and becomes part of a wiser version of you. It can herald achievements, goals reached, travel or the feeling of being exactly where you're meant to be. Enjoy this moment and give yourself the recognition you deserve. But remember that the end of one cycle is also the start of another: The World connects back to The Fool, like a dance that never ends. Be grateful for the road you've travelled and get ready, joyfully, for the next adventure. You have so much to celebrate.

REVERSED

Reversed, The World can mean you're very close to completing a cycle, but something is stopping you from taking the final step. Perhaps there's a loose end, a fear of finishing or a feeling that it's still not enough. It can also reflect looking for shortcuts to get there sooner. Look at what's missing for you to feel at peace with this ending, and give yourself permission to complete it. Closing a chapter well is what gives strength to the next one.

♥ IN LOVE

It points to fulfilling, harmonious relationships, or the culmination of an important stage in your love life. It can also speak of feeling whole on your own, which allows you to love from a place of abundance rather than lack.

♦ AT WORK

It heralds the completion of projects, goals achieved and recognition. It's a good time to celebrate, take stock and set your sights on new horizons, perhaps broader ones or with an international reach. What you've learned is your best luggage.

TARA'S ADVICE

Celebrate everything you've achieved, and embrace the new cycle that's beginning with gratitude.

FOR YOUR JOURNAL

Which cycle in my life is coming to completion, and what have I learned from it that I want to carry into the next?

CHAPTER 4



The Minor Arcana

The four suits and the court cards

The 56 Minor Arcana speak of everyday life: what we feel, what we think, what we do and what we build. If the Major Arcana are the great chapters of your story, the Minor Arcana are the scenes of each day. They are organised into four suits, the same four suits found in traditional European decks (the ones the suits of playing cards come from), and each suit has ten numbered cards and four court cards.

♦ THE FOUR SUITS

SUIT	ELEMENT	SPEAKS OF...
Wands	Fire	Action, passion, creativity, energy, projects and ambition.
Cups	Water	Emotions, love, relationships, intuition and dreams.
Swords	Air	Mind, words, truth, decisions and conflicts.
Pentacles	Earth	Money, work, the body, home and everything material.

♦ THE LANGUAGE OF NUMBERS

A trick for learning the Minor Arcana without memorising 40 meanings: each number has its own energy that repeats across all four suits. If you know what the number means and what the suit means, you can work out the meaning of the card. For example: Three speaks of growth and Cups of emotions, so the Three of Cups is joy shared with friends.

NUMBER	ENERGY
Ace	The seed, the beginning, the pure potential of the suit.
Two	Choice, duality, meeting the other.
Three	Growth, expression, the first fruits.
Four	Stability, structure, sometimes stagnation.
Five	Crisis, conflict, uncomfortable change.

Six	Harmony regained, generosity, moving forward.
Seven	The test, reflection, strategy.
Eight	Movement, effort, power set in motion.
Nine	Almost complete fulfilment, intensity.
Ten	The end of a cycle, fullness or excess.

✦ THE COURT CARDS

The court cards are the ones beginners find hardest, because they can speak of three things: another person in your life, a part of yourself or an attitude the situation is asking of you. Ask yourself which of the three fits your reading best.

COURT CARD	REPRESENTS
Page	The apprentice: curiosity, messages, first steps. Often a young person or a piece of news.
Knight	Action and movement: someone chasing something with intensity, sometimes without moderation.
Queen	Inner maturity: masters the energy of the suit from within, with sensitivity and wisdom.
King	Outer maturity: masters the energy of the suit outwardly, with authority and responsibility.

Court cards have no fixed gender: a Queen can speak of a man and a King of a woman. What matters is the energy, not the person.



Wands

The suit of fire: the spark that gets you out of bed in the morning. The Wands speak of your drive, your creativity, your projects and the way you take action. When many appear in a spread, the situation calls for movement, initiative and enthusiasm.



ACE OF WANDS

inspiration

new beginnings

creative spark

potential

feeling blocked

delays

scattered energy

Upright. A hand emerges from the clouds and offers you a wand covered in green shoots: it's the spark of something that wants to be born. The Ace of Wands brings fresh energy, sudden inspiration and the urge to dive in. It might be an idea that keeps you up at night, a creative project or the desire to change direction. This card doesn't ask you to have it all figured out; it asks you to dare to take the first step while the fire is still burning. The opportunity is there; what you do with it is up to you.

Reversed. Reversed, the Ace speaks of a spark that won't quite catch. Maybe you feel the urge but don't know where to start, or fear of getting it wrong is holding you back. It can also point to spreading your energy across too many fronts. Ask yourself what dims your fire and what you'd need to light it again.

♦ Listen to that idea pulsing inside you, and give it one small, concrete gesture today.



TWO OF WANDS

planning

vision

decision

horizons

fear of the unknown

indecision

comfort zone

Upright. From the top of a castle wall, a figure holds a small globe and gazes out at the horizon. The Two of Wands is the moment the initial spark becomes a plan. You already know what you want; now it's time to decide where to aim it. This card speaks of long-term vision, healthy ambition and looking beyond the familiar. You have the resources and the ability, but also a choice to make: stay where you feel safe, or go out and explore what's waiting for you.

Reversed. When it appears reversed, the Two suggests that fear of the unknown is weighing more than the desire to move forward. You may be planning a lot and moving very little, or comfort may be quietly stealing your dreams. Check whether your plans are truly yours or ones you inherited from other people.

♦ Sketch out your horizon without fear, and choose a first path even if you can't see where it ends.



♂ THREE OF WANDS

expansion

perspective

progress

active waiting

obstacles

impatience

lack of foresight

Upright. Someone stands on a clifftop watching ships sail out to sea. What you planted is starting to move, and you can already see the first results in the distance. The Three of Wands speaks of expansion, of projects that grow and of opening yourself to new experiences, even travel or collaborations. It's a card of trust: you did your part, and now it's about keeping your eyes on the long view. This isn't the time to stop, but to get ready for what's coming while you keep patiently feeding your purpose.

Reversed. Reversed, the Three can reflect frustration that things aren't moving at the pace you hoped. Perhaps something unexpected came up, or you misjudged the timing. It isn't a failure, but an invitation to review your course, adjust your expectations and remember why you set out on this journey.

♦ *Trust what you've already set in motion, and look far ahead with a peaceful heart.*



♂ FOUR OF WANDS

celebration

home

harmony

shared success

tension at home

instability

postponed celebration

Upright. Four wands decked with garlands form a festive archway, and behind it people raise their arms in joy. The Four of Wands is one of the brightest cards in the suit: it celebrates a milestone, a stage completed or a place where you finally feel at home. It speaks of community, happy gatherings and solid foundations to keep building on. It reminds you that stopping to enjoy what you've achieved is part of the journey too, and that sharing joy multiplies it.

Reversed. Reversed, this card can point to a harmony that's wobbling, perhaps tension with the people closest to you or a feeling of not quite fitting in. Sometimes it means you find it hard to celebrate your own achievements. Ask yourself what you need in order to feel at home within yourself.

♦ *Celebrate what you've achieved, and surround yourself with the people who fill your home with light.*



♂ FIVE OF WANDS

competition

conflict

clashing opinions

challenge

avoiding conflict

inner tension

agreement

Upright. Five young men brandish their wands in what looks like a fight, though no one gets hurt. The Five of Wands reflects friction, competition and clashing ideas. It might be a team where everyone wants to be right, a rivalry, or your own mind torn between several desires. This card isn't negative in itself: conflict can be creative too, if it's channelled well. It invites you to listen to other voices, to stand up for yourself without aggression and to see what might be born from the chaos.

Reversed. Reversed, the Five suggests you're avoiding a necessary conversation, or that the tension has stayed bottled up inside you. It can also signal that the conflict is calming down and it's time to come to an agreement. Notice whether you're keeping quiet for the sake of real peace, or out of fear.

♦ *Stand up for your voice respectfully, and leave room for other voices to be heard too.*



♂ SIX OF WANDS

victory

recognition

confidence

public success

insecurity

lack of recognition

ego

Upright. A rider crowned with laurels moves through a cheering crowd. It's the image of a well-deserved triumph, of hard work finally being seen. The Six of Wands brings recognition, good news and the confidence that comes from having overcome a challenge. Others may be valuing your work, or you may be starting to believe in your own abilities. Enjoy it without false modesty, but remember that true success is sustained by humility and by gratitude towards those who walked with you.

Reversed. When it comes up reversed, the Six can speak of an achievement that doesn't get the applause you hoped for, or of relying too much on other people's approval. It also warns of pride that pushes people away. Your worth doesn't depend on how many people are watching; it starts with recognising yourself.

♦ *Welcome your achievements with joy, and share the crown with those who helped you.*



SEVEN OF WANDS

standing your ground

perseverance

conviction

resilience

exhaustion

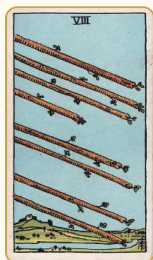
giving up

feeling overwhelmed

Upright. From higher ground, a figure fends off six wands pushing up from below. They have the advantage, though the struggle demands firmness. The Seven of Wands appears when you need to hold your position in the face of criticism, pressure or competition. It speaks of courage, of believing in what you do and of not giving up ground just to please others. You've come a long way, and it's natural for some people to question you. This card reminds you that your convictions deserve to be defended with calm and determination.

Reversed. Reversed, the Seven shows the weariness of fighting for so long. Maybe you feel as if everyone is against you, or that you've run out of strength. Ask yourself which battles are truly worth it and which you can let go of without betraying yourself. Protecting your energy is a form of strength too.

♦ *Stand firm in what you know is yours, and choose your battles wisely.*



EIGHT OF WANDS

speed

movement

news

progress

delays

haste

frustration

Upright. Eight wands fly through the sky side by side, like arrows shot towards their target. There are no people in the scene, only pure movement. The Eight of Wands announces that things are speeding up: messages arriving, decisions made all at once, projects finally taking off. After a period of waiting, the energy is flowing and everything seems to click into place. It's a good time to act quickly, ride the momentum and go with the flow without losing sight of where you're heading.

Reversed. Reversed, the Eight can point to delays, messages that don't arrive or plans that stall for no apparent reason. It also warns against rushing into mistakes. Breathe, check the details and remember that everything has its own rhythm. What's meant for you will find its moment.

♦ *Make the most of the tailwind and move decisively, without forgetting your course.*



♠ NINE OF WANDS

resilience

persistence

caution

the final test

exhaustion

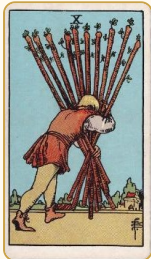
mistrust

giving up too soon

Upright. With a bandaged head and leaning on his wand, a man keeps watch behind a row of staves. He's been through a lot, and he's still standing. The Nine of Wands speaks of the strength that shows up just when you think you have nothing left. You're close to the finish line, even if tiredness makes you doubt it. This card honours your resilience and asks for one last push, but it also reminds you that caution shouldn't turn into mistrust of everything that comes your way.

Reversed. Reversed, the Nine reflects an exhaustion that's asking for rest. You may be so much on the defensive that you no longer let help in. Lowering your guard for a moment isn't giving up; sometimes it's exactly what allows you to keep going. Your strength also lies in knowing how to rest.

♦ *Acknowledge everything you've endured, and give yourself permission to ask for support on the final stretch.*



♠ TEN OF WANDS

burden

responsibility

overwork

pressure

putting the weight down

delegating

burnout

Upright. A figure walks hunched over, clutching ten wands that almost block their view. The destination is close, but the load is enormous. The Ten of Wands appears when you're carrying too much: tasks, commitments or expectations that may not even be yours. What started as passion has turned into obligation. This card doesn't judge you; it gently shows you that you don't have to do it all on your own. Look at what you can delegate, what you can put off and what you can simply set down.

Reversed. Reversed, this card can mean you're finally starting to let go of burdens or to ask for help. At other times it warns that the load has become unsustainable and your body is asking you to stop. Listen to yourself before you reach your limit, and choose what you want to keep carrying.

♦ *Set down what doesn't belong to you, and walk lighter towards what you love.*



♂ PAGE OF WANDS

enthusiasm

curiosity

exploration

messages

lack of direction

immaturity

half-formed ideas

Upright. A young man in a desert landscape gazes at his wand in wonder, like someone who has just discovered treasure. The Page of Wands represents an enthusiastic, curious person full of ideas, often young at heart, who wants to try everything. As an attitude, it invites you to explore fearlessly, to play with your creativity and to open yourself to news that lights you up. It's the energy of the apprentice who hasn't yet mastered their fire, but feels it burning with strength and joy.

Reversed. Reversed, the Page speaks of enthusiasm that fizzles out quickly, of starting lots of things and finishing none. It can point to someone impulsive, or to too many ideas with no direction. Choose a single spark and tend it until it grows. Consistency can be fun too.

♦ *Dare to explore as if it were the first time, and let curiosity be your guide.*



♂ KNIGHT OF WANDS

boldness

adventure

passion

drive

impulsiveness

recklessness

inconsistency

Upright. On a rearing horse, this rider charges forward with his wand held high. The Knight of Wands embodies a passionate, brave and charismatic person who lives intensely and can't stand routine. As an attitude, he encourages you to get moving, to chase what you want with energy and not to sit around waiting for the perfect moment. He brings adventure, changes of scene and an appetite to take on the world. His challenge is making sure the fire that drives him doesn't turn into a haste that burns everything in its path.

Reversed. Reversed, the Knight shows the impatient side of passion: rash decisions, projects abandoned halfway or someone who is charming but unreliable. Ask yourself whether you're running towards something or away from something. Tempering your drive doesn't mean putting it out. You only need to aim it at where you truly want to go.

♦ *Chase your passion bravely, but look at the path before you leap.*



♠ QUEEN OF WANDS

confidence

charisma

warmth

determination

insecurity

jealousy

exhaustion

Upright. Seated on her throne with a sunflower in her hand and a black cat at her feet, the Queen of Wands radiates confidence. She represents a warm, self-assured, creative and magnetic person, able to juggle many things at once without losing her joy. She knows her worth and encourages others to shine. As an attitude, she invites you to take up your space without asking permission, to trust your intuition and to let your natural light guide your decisions.

Reversed. Reversed, the Queen can reflect wounded confidence: doubts about your worth, comparisons or jealousy. It can also speak of someone who gives so much that they run out of energy. Rekindle your fire by looking after yourself first and remembering who you are. Your light is still there, even if today it's burning a little lower.

♦ *Shine without asking permission, and let your warmth open doors all around you.*



♠ KING OF WANDS

leadership

vision

entrepreneurship

inspiration

domineering

impatience

unrealistic expectations

Upright. On his throne decorated with lions and salamanders, the King of Wands looks ahead with determination. He symbolises a leader, a visionary and an entrepreneur, someone who knows how to turn ideas into reality and spread enthusiasm through his team. He has learned to master his fire and uses it to guide, not to destroy. As an attitude, he suggests you take charge of your life, make brave decisions and think big, without losing your integrity or forgetting the people who walk beside you.

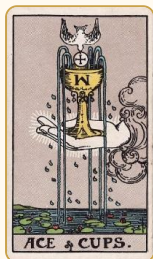
Reversed. Reversed, the King can become domineering, impatient or overly demanding, of himself and of others. It also reflects someone with big plans who doesn't listen much. True leadership means inspiring, not imposing; take a look at how you use your power. The most solid authority comes from integrity.

♦ *Take the reins of your purpose, and lead by example with an open heart.*



Cups

The suit of water: the world of emotions. The Cups speak of love in all its forms, of friendship, of intuition and of what you feel, even if you don't say it. When many appear in a spread, what matters is in the heart.



ACE OF CUPS

new love

emotional openness

intuition

fulfilment

emotional block

emptiness

self-love still to come

Upright. A hand emerges from a cloud holding an overflowing chalice; five streams of water pour into a pool full of water lilies. The Ace of Cups is the beginning of everything we feel: a love being born, a sincere friendship, an emotion that brings you back to life. It also speaks of compassion, of creativity flowing from the heart and of an awakened intuition. This card invites you to open up, to let yourself be moved and to receive, without fear, whatever arrives with tenderness.

Reversed. Reversed, the Ace suggests that your cup is closed or empty. Perhaps you protect yourself so much that you don't let affection in, or you give without receiving anything back. Before looking outside yourself, ask how you could fill your own cup with self-love.

♦ *Open your heart a little more today, and let something beautiful in.*



TWO OF CUPS

union

reciprocity

connection

attraction

imbalance

drifting apart

misunderstandings

Upright. Two people look into each other's eyes and exchange cups, while above them rises a caduceus topped with a winged lion's head. The Two of Cups celebrates the meeting of two souls who recognise each other. It may be a romantic relationship, a deep friendship or a partnership built on mutual respect. What matters most here is reciprocity: giving and receiving in equal measure. This card speaks of relationships that nourish you, of reconciliations that are possible and of the beauty of feeling seen and understood.

Reversed. Reversed, the Two signals that something has become unbalanced in a relationship: one person is giving more than the other, or communication has cooled. It can also invite you to look at your relationship with yourself. Healthy love begins with respect and listening.

♦ *Nurture the relationships where you can be yourself, and offer what you'd like to receive.*



☪ THREE OF CUPS

friendship

celebration

community

shared joy

overindulgence

isolation

gossip

Upright. Three women raise their cups in a toast in a garden full of fruit. The Three of Cups is the card of friendship, celebrations and support between equals. It speaks of happy gatherings, reunions and that network of people who hold you up in good times and bad. It also reflects the creativity that's born in a group. It reminds you that shared joy weighs less and shines brighter, and that you don't have to walk the path alone.

Reversed. Reversed, the Three can speak of overdoing the celebrations, of groups where rumours fly or of feeling left out of the circle. Sometimes it means you need a little solitude to find yourself again. Choose to surround yourself with people who truly add to your life.

✦ *Celebrate life's gifts with your people, and raise a glass to the small victories.*



☪ FOUR OF CUPS

apathy

introspection

dissatisfaction

overlooked opportunity

awakening

renewed motivation

accepting what's offered

Upright. Sitting under a tree with his arms crossed, a young man looks listlessly at three cups and doesn't see the fourth being offered to him by a hand from a cloud. The Four of Cups reflects that moment when nothing really excites you. It might be tiredness, boredom or a gentle sadness that turns you in on yourself. This card doesn't reproach you for pausing, because introspection is necessary too, but it whispers that there may be something valuable right in front of you that you aren't looking at yet.

Reversed. When it appears reversed, the Four announces that you're beginning to come out of your apathy. Your curiosity returns, you accept an offer or you see clearly what you used to ignore. It's a small awakening; support it with simple gestures that bring back your enthusiasm.

✦ *Lift your gaze for a moment, and notice what life is offering you.*



☪ FIVE OF CUPS

loss

disappointment

grief

regret

acceptance

healing

moving on

Upright. Wrapped in a black cloak, a figure weeps over three spilled cups, without noticing the two still standing behind. The Five of Cups speaks of disappointment, of something that didn't turn out as you hoped and of pain that needs its own time. This card honours your sadness and doesn't ask you to hide it. Yet it gently reminds you that not everything is lost: there are still resources, loved ones and paths waiting for you. In the distance, a bridge invites you to cross when you feel the time is right.

Reversed. Reversed, the Five shows that grief is starting to turn into acceptance. You turn towards what remains and slowly find your hope again. It can also point to holding on too tightly to the past. Forgiving yourself is part of healing. There's no rush: every wound heals in its own time.

✦ *Cry what you need to cry and, when you can, turn towards what's still standing.*



SIX OF CUPS

nostalgia

childhood

innocence

memories

stuck in the past

idealising

growing up

Upright. In a peaceful courtyard, a boy offers a girl a cup full of flowers. The Six of Cups awakens the heart's memory: childhood, happy memories, simple tenderness. It may herald reunions with people from your past, returns to beloved places or the need to reconnect with your inner child. This card invites you to rediscover innocence, generosity with no strings attached and the pleasure of simple things, remembering what made you happy before life got complicated.

Reversed. Reversed, the Six warns that nostalgia can become a cage. Perhaps you're idealising a time gone by, or finding it hard to accept that things have changed. Honour what you've lived, but don't forget that your present deserves tenderness too. The best of yesterday can inspire your tomorrow.

♦ *Recapture the simple joy you felt as a child, and bring it as a gift to your present.*



SEVEN OF CUPS

illusions

options

imagination

fantasy

clarity

decision

back to reality

Upright. Seven cups float among the clouds, and each one holds something different: jewels, a castle, a snake, a veiled figure. The Seven of Cups speaks of many possibilities and an overflowing imagination. It's the card of dreams and desires, and also of mirages. You have several tempting options in front of you, but not all of them are what they seem. It asks you to tell the difference between what you truly want and what merely glitters, and to bring your dreams down to earth with a real step.

Reversed. Reversed, the Seven brings clarity after confusion. The fantasies fade and you can see honestly what's good for you. It's a good time to choose. Sometimes it also warns that you're afraid to decide because you don't want to give anything up. Choosing one path opens doors too.

♦ *Dream big, but choose just one cup and start making it real.*



EIGHT OF CUPS

walking away

searching

detachment

inner growth

fear of leaving

stagnation

indecision

Upright. By the light of the moon, a figure walks away, leaving behind eight carefully stacked cups. They aren't running away: they're choosing to leave. The Eight of Cups appears when something that once fulfilled you no longer does, even if on the surface you have it all. It speaks of the courage to let go, of searching for deeper meaning and of following your inner calling even when others don't understand it. This card reminds you that walking away from what no longer nourishes you can be an act of self-love.

Reversed. Reversed, the Eight shows the fear of leaving a place, a relationship or a stage of life that no longer makes you happy. You may be torn between staying out of habit and setting off into the unknown. Listen to what your body tells you when you imagine it.

♦ *Honour what was, and find the courage to walk towards what truly fulfils you.*



☪ NINE OF CUPS

contentment

wish fulfilled

gratitude

wellbeing

dissatisfaction

overindulgence

inner emptiness

Upright. A smiling man sits with his arms folded in front of nine cups lined up behind him. It's the well-known wish card: the Nine of Cups heralds contentment, pleasure and the feeling that things are going well. It speaks of enjoying what you've achieved, of emotional wellbeing and of gratitude. It encourages you to acknowledge your joys, big and small, without guilt. That said, it also invites you to ask yourself whether what you wish for will truly make you happy, or only give you a fleeting pleasure.

Reversed. Reversed, the Nine suggests that even though you have what you asked for, something still isn't quite filling you up. It can reflect overindulgence, complacency or desires that were never really yours. Ask yourself again what makes you happy on the inside, beyond what's visible.

♦ *Savour the good things you already have, and give thanks for every full cup.*



☪ TEN OF CUPS

family harmony

happiness

emotional fulfilment

home

disconnection

idealised expectations

conflict at home

Upright. A couple in each other's arms gaze up at a rainbow of ten cups while their children play near a cosy house. The Ten of Cups is the culmination of the suit: shared love, peace at home and a sense of belonging. It isn't about perfection, but about genuine bonds where you can be who you are. It may refer to the family you were born into or the one you choose. This card reminds you that true abundance is emotional, and it's built day by day, with care and presence.

Reversed. Reversed, the Ten can point to tension at home, emotional distance or the pressure to fit an idealised picture of happiness. No family is a perfect painting. Look for real connection rather than appearances, and start by nurturing your relationship with yourself.

♦ *Tend, day after day, the bonds that make you feel at home, with patience and presence.*



☪ PAGE OF CUPS

sensitivity

emotional surprise

creativity

tenderness

emotional immaturity

touchiness

too much fantasy

Upright. By the sea, an elegant young man watches in surprise as a fish pops its head out of his cup. The Page of Cups represents a sensitive, dreamy and intuitive person with a tender heart and a rich imagination. As an attitude, it invites you to look at your emotions with curiosity, to let yourself be surprised and to express what you feel creatively. It may bring affectionate messages, unexpected offers or the awakening of an artistic talent. Listen to the little signs your intuition sends you.

Reversed. Reversed, the Page can reflect someone emotionally immature, who takes offence easily or hides away in fantasy. It also points to creative blocks or feelings you don't dare to show. Give the youngest part of you a safe space to express itself.

♦ *Let life surprise you, and let your sensitivity be your gift.*



KNIGHT OF CUPS

romance

idealism

offers

sensitivity

empty promises

mood swings

escapism

Upright. Riding a white horse that moves forward calmly, the Knight of Cups holds his chalice like someone bearing an offering. He represents a romantic, idealistic and charming person who is led by the heart and looks for beauty in everything. As an attitude, he suggests you follow your feelings, express affection without fear and pursue your dreams with grace. He may herald invitations, declarations or creative proposals. His challenge is to bring his ideals down to earth and follow through on what he promises.

Reversed. Reversed, the Knight shows his more volatile side: promises that aren't kept, mood swings or idealising so much that he runs from reality. It can describe someone seductive but unreliable. Notice whether the actions match the words.

♦ *Follow your heart tenderly, and make sure your actions live up to your dreams.*



QUEEN OF CUPS

empathy

intuition

compassion

emotional calm

emotional dependency

blurred boundaries

emotional exhaustion

Upright. Seated at the water's edge, the Queen of Cups gazes at an ornate, closed chalice, a symbol of her inner world. She represents a deeply empathetic, intuitive and compassionate person, someone who knows how to listen and hold space without judging. She feels a great deal, but she doesn't drown in her emotions. As an attitude, she invites you to trust your intuition, to care for others from a place of calm and to treat yourself with the same gentleness you offer. Her power lies in a peaceful heart.

Reversed. Reversed, the Queen can reflect someone who absorbs other people's emotions until they lose themselves, or who depends on others' affection to feel good. It also points to blurred boundaries. Caring doesn't mean carrying everything; protect your energy so you can keep giving.

♦ *Listen to your intuition, and care for yourself with the same tenderness you show others.*



🥃 KING OF CUPS

emotional balance

wisdom

diplomacy

generosity

bottled-up emotions

manipulation

coldness

Upright. On a throne floating on a choppy sea, the King of Cups stays calm, with a cup in one hand and a sceptre in the other. He symbolises a mature, diplomatic and compassionate person who has learned to manage his emotions without suppressing them. He knows how to give advice, mediate conflicts and keep calm when everything around him is moving. As an attitude, he encourages you to bring heart and mind together, to respond rather than react and to offer support from a place of inner stability.

Reversed. Reversed, the King may hide his feelings behind a cold front or use empathy to manipulate. It also reflects held-back emotions that end up spilling over. Acknowledging what you feel, without judging it, is the first step towards finding your balance again. Your emotions aren't a weakness; they're a compass.

♦ *Stay calm in the middle of the waves, and let your heart and mind work together.*



Swords

The suit of air: the mind and the word. The Swords speak of thoughts, decisions, truths and conflicts. They carry the toughest images, but don't be frightened: they show the mental knots so that you can untie them. When many appear, it's time to think clearly and communicate honestly.



♠ ACE OF SWORDS

clarity

truth

lucidity

decision

· confusion

hurtful words

scattered ideas

Upright. A crowned sword rises out of the clouds and cuts through the fog in a single stroke. That is how this card enters your life: as a flash of clarity. It is the moment you finally understand something that has been going round in your head for a long time, the clear idea that puts everything else in order. It speaks of truth, of an awake mind and of the courage to call things by their name. If you have a decision waiting, the Ace invites you to look at it with clear eyes, without embellishments or excuses.

Reversed. When it appears reversed, that clarity clouds over. You may be thinking so much that you never reach a conclusion, or using words as weapons instead of bridges. It also points to brilliant ideas that stay up in the air. Breathe, put your thoughts in order and wait for the fog to lift before you act.

♦ *Speak your truth calmly and let clarity open the way for you.*



♠ TWO OF SWORDS

indecision

truce

stalemate

fragile balance

· pressure

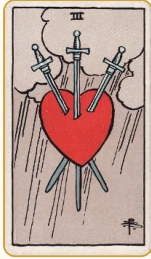
overload

truth revealed

Upright. A blindfolded figure holds two crossed swords against the chest, back turned to a calm sea under the moon. This card describes that deadlock where you don't want to choose because every option seems to cost something. There is a truce, a delicate balance, but also a certain reluctance to look at what you really feel. Tara reminds you that not deciding is also a way of deciding. Take off the blindfold little by little: the answer you are looking for is closer than you think.

Reversed. Reversed, the accumulated tension begins to spill over. Perhaps contradictory information overwhelms you, or you feel others are pushing you to choose right now. It can also mean that the blindfold finally falls and you see what you had been avoiding. Before listening to everyone else, listen to yourself.

♦ *Give yourself a moment of silence and listen to what your heart already knows.*



‡ THREE OF SWORDS

sorrow

heartbreak

painful truth

emotional release

healing

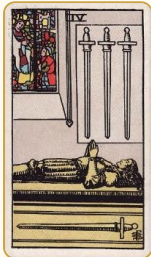
forgiveness

pain held inside

Upright. A heart pierced by three swords under a rainy sky: few images in the tarot are so direct. This card puts a name to sorrow, to disappointment, to words that hurt or a truth that is hard to accept. It doesn't come to frighten you, but to give you permission to feel. Rain also cleanses, and the tears you let out today are the ones that won't stay stuck tomorrow. Acknowledging the wound is the first step towards it beginning to close. And it will close.

Reversed. Reversed, it suggests that the pain is beginning to loosen its grip. Forgiveness arrives, towards others or towards yourself, and the sadness grows lighter. Sometimes, however, it warns of a sorrow locked away for fear of feeling it. Opening it with care, perhaps sharing it with someone you trust, will give you back your lightness.

♦ *Allow yourself to feel what hurts and trust that your heart knows how to heal at its own pace.*



‡ FOUR OF SWORDS

rest

pause

recovery

introspection

exhaustion

restlessness

return to action

Upright. In the silence of a temple, a figure rests with hands joined while light streams in through a stained-glass window. After the mental battle, it is time to stop. The Four of Swords speaks of rest, of voluntary retreat and of regaining strength before returning to action. It isn't giving up: it's recharging. If your mind has been racing for a long time, this card asks you to turn down the volume of the world, to meditate, to sleep well or simply to give yourself a break without guilt.

Reversed. Reversed, it can show that you resist stopping even though your mind is worn out or, on the contrary, that the rest has gone on so long it now feels like stagnation. It also announces the moment to return to activity gradually. Find your own balance between pause and movement.

♦ *Give yourself a time of calm, because resting is also a way of moving forward.*



† FIVE OF SWORDS

conflict

pride

hollow victory

tension

reconciliation

lingering resentment

closing wounds

Upright. Someone gathers the swords from the ground with a half-smile while others walk away with their heads bowed towards the shore. The Five of Swords portrays those arguments in which one side wins but everyone loses something along the way. It speaks of pride, of tension and of wanting to be right at any cost. Ask yourself where you stand in the scene: are you the one who imposes or the one who withdraws, wounded? This card invites you to weigh whether that battle truly deserves your energy or whether it's better to let it go and choose peace.

Reversed. Reversed, it points to reconciliation after a confrontation or a sincere wish to leave old grudges behind. It can also indicate resentments that are still throbbing beneath the surface. It's a good moment to reach out, to apologise or, quite simply, to close the chapter with dignity.

♦ *Choose peace over being right when what's at stake is your own tranquillity.*



† SIX OF SWORDS

transition

leaving behind

journey

calm after the storm

resistance to change

delays

emotional baggage

Upright. A boat glides slowly towards the far shore, carrying a woman and a child guided by a ferryman. Behind them the water is choppy; ahead, calm can be glimpsed. The Six of Swords speaks of transitions, of leaving a difficult stage behind even if it still weighs on you a little. It may reflect a move, a journey or an inner movement towards a more peaceful place. You don't need to have everything worked out: it's enough to keep rowing towards wherever you breathe more easily.

Reversed. Reversed, the crossing becomes more complicated. Perhaps you feel something tying you to the shore you want to leave, or an important change is being delayed. It also speaks of emotional baggage you haven't yet put down. Look at what you are carrying that you no longer need in order to move on.

♦ *Move forward with patience, because calmer waters are already waiting for you.*



SEVEN OF SWORDS

strategy

cunning

discretion

secrets

honesty

confession

self-deception

Upright. A man tiptoes away from a camp with five swords in his arms, glancing back over his shoulder. This card has two faces: on one side, cunning, strategy and the ability to act with discretion; on the other, deception or the feeling that something isn't being told in full. It may invite you to check whether someone is playing with an advantage or whether you are the one avoiding the direct route. Being resourceful is valuable, as long as it doesn't take you away from your integrity.

Reversed. Reversed, secrets tend to come to light. It can point to a confession, a decision to stop hiding or a wish to act with more transparency. It also warns about self-deception: those stories you tell yourself so as not to face something you already sense deep down.

♦ *Act with ingenuity, but let honesty remain your compass.*



EIGHT OF SWORDS

mental block

fear

feeling trapped

self-limitation

liberation

new perspectives

confidence regained

Upright. A bound, blindfolded figure stands surrounded by swords stuck in the mud. She seems trapped, but if you look closely, the bindings are loose and there is room to leave. The Eight of Swords speaks of mental blocks, of fears that build invisible cages. Often that prison is made of thoughts like "I can't" or "it's not possible". The good news is that what your mind has shut in, your mind can also set free, step by step.

Reversed. Reversed, it is one of the most hopeful cards in the suit: it announces that you are beginning to loosen the ropes. You see options where before there were only walls, and you regain confidence in yourself. If you still feel that something is holding you back, ask for help: you don't have to free yourself alone.

♦ *Question your fears, because the way out may be just one step away.*



† NINE OF SWORDS

worry

anxiety

night-time thoughts

guilt

· relief

hope

hidden unease

Upright. Someone sits up in bed in the small hours, face in hands. Behind, nine swords hang on a dark wall. This is the card of worries that grow at night, of thoughts that go round and round without rest. But notice: the swords don't touch the figure. A great deal of that anguish lives in the mind and not in the facts. Tara whispers that you have more resources than you think: putting a name to what troubles you and sharing it usually makes it much smaller.

Reversed. Reversed, the inner storm begins to calm and you discover that some fears were exaggerated. At other times, it points to an unease so tightly held that it needs to come out. Talking with someone you trust, or seeking professional support if you need it, can bring enormous relief.

♦ *Switch on a light in your night and share what weighs on you with someone who loves you well.*



† TEN OF SWORDS

end of a cycle

hitting bottom

surrender

new dawn

· recovery

resistance to letting go

rebirth

Upright. A figure lies face down with ten swords in the back, a dramatic image that strikes you at first sight. But look at the horizon: the black sky opens onto a golden dawn. The Ten of Swords marks the close of a painful stage, that moment when you feel things can't get any worse. And precisely for that reason, the hardest part is behind you. It symbolises hitting bottom in order to push off, accepting that something has ended and letting the new day arrive.

Reversed. Reversed, it speaks of recovery: you get up, even if slowly, and gather what you have learned. At times it also points to resistance to accepting that something is over, which prolongs the suffering. Truly letting go is what opens the door to your rebirth and to a lighter stage.

♦ *Let go of what has ended and turn your gaze towards the dawn.*



♠ PAGE OF SWORDS

curiosity

vigilance

new ideas

messages

gossip

haste

defensiveness

Upright. A young person holds a sword high on windswept ground, alert and watchful. The Page of Swords represents mental curiosity, the eagerness to learn, investigate and ask questions. As a person, this card describes someone young in spirit, sharp, talkative and a little impatient, who picks up details others overlook. It can also announce news or messages that call for your attention. Its energy encourages you to observe before judging and to keep your mind fresh.

Reversed. Reversed, that curiosity can turn into gossip, easy criticism or words spoken without thinking. It may reflect someone who promises a lot and delivers little, or a defensive attitude towards any comment. By all means ask questions, but listen to the answers with an open heart too.

♦ *Learn with curiosity and speak when your words add something.*



♠ KNIGHT OF SWORDS

determination

speed

frankness

ambition

impulsiveness

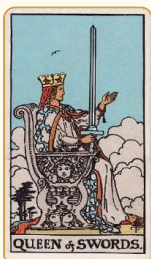
verbal aggression

scattered focus

Upright. At full gallop, sword out in front and wind in his face, the Knight of Swords knows no pause. He symbolises swift action guided by ideas, determination and the courage to defend what you think. As a person, he is direct, brilliant, passionate about his causes and, at times, not very diplomatic. His arrival signals movement: matters speeding up, intense debates, decisions made in the heat of the moment. Make the most of his drive, but remember to brake before every bend.

Reversed. Reversed, the drive turns into haste. It can speak of impulsiveness, needless arguments or projects that start with force and are left half done. It also describes someone who hurts with their words without realising. Slow down before you charge.

♦ *Defend your ideas with passion, but let calm set the pace.*



♠ QUEEN OF SWORDS

lucidity

independence

honesty

clear boundaries

coldness

sharp criticism

bitterness

Upright. Seated on her throne among the clouds, the Queen of Swords extends one open hand while the other holds her sword upright. She is the wisdom born of experience, even of loss. As a person, she represents someone lucid, independent and sincere, who tells the truth with elegance and is not easily fooled. Beneath her apparent coolness beats a great understanding. This card invites you to set clear boundaries and to trust your own judgement.

Reversed. Reversed, clarity can harden into severity: sharp criticism, emotional distance or bitterness over old wounds. It can also mean you find it hard to think objectively because emotions are clouding your judgement. Remember that truth spoken with affection travels much further than truth that cuts.

♦ *Speak with clarity and tenderness together, because your truth deserves to be heard.*



♠ KING OF SWORDS

authority

reason

justice

ethics

· manipulation

rigidity

abuse of power

Upright. The King of Swords presides serenely, sword steady and gaze straight ahead, while butterflies adorn his throne. He embodies the authority that comes from knowledge, ethics and strategic thinking. As a person, he is rational, fair and highly analytical, someone who listens to all sides before deciding. He may represent a mentor or anyone whose word carries weight. In your reading, he asks you to act from reason, with clear principles and without giving in to outside pressure.

Reversed. Reversed, intelligence is put at the service of control or manipulation. It can reflect rigidity, coldness or abuse of authority, in other people or in yourself. It also warns of decisions made without thinking about those who will be affected. Balance reason with humanity.

♦ *Decide with a clear head and your heart present.*



Pentacles

The suit of earth: what you can touch. The Pentacles speak of work, money, the body, the home and the patience of building step by step. When many appear in a spread, the answer lies in the practical and the concrete.



ACE OF PENTACLES

opportunity

prosperity

new beginning

stability

missed opportunity

insecurity

unrealistic plans

Upright. A hand emerges from a cloud offering a golden coin and, beneath it, a well-kept garden blooms with an archway inviting you through. The Ace of Pentacles is a seed of prosperity: a concrete opportunity, a project that can put down roots, the possibility of building something solid. It also speaks of the body, of connection with the earth and of the pleasure of simple things. What is born with this card is not smoke: it is real, tangible, and it grows if you tend it.

Reversed. Reversed, the opportunity may pass you by through lack of preparation or too many doubts. It also points to unrealistic plans or a relationship with the material world marked by insecurity. Go back to basics, put your feet on the ground and build from what you already have.

✦ *Plant your seed today with patience and tend it every day.*



TWO OF PENTACLES

balance

adaptability

flexibility

juggling

disorganisation

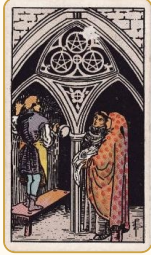
overload

confused priorities

Upright. A young man dances as he juggles two coins joined by an infinity loop; behind him, ships rise and fall on the waves. The Two of Pentacles speaks of balance in motion: sharing your time, energy and resources among several responsibilities. It is everyday flexibility, the ability to adapt to change without losing your rhythm. You may have many fronts open, but this card reminds you that you can handle them lightly and even with a certain joy.

Reversed. Reversed, the juggling gets out of control. Too many tasks, confused priorities or the feeling that something is about to slip from your hands. It can also point to disorder in how you organise yourself. It's time to simplify, delegate and say no to what isn't essential.

✦ *Dance with the changes and put your priorities in order, calmly.*



★ THREE OF PENTACLES

collaboration

craft

recognition

teamwork

lack of coordination

lack of care

feeling undervalued

Upright. Inside a cathedral, a craftsman works standing on a bench while two people go over the plans with him. The Three of Pentacles celebrates work well done and collaboration. Your talent is starting to be recognised and others value what you contribute. It speaks of learning, of craft and of building something lasting as a team. If you're in the middle of a project, it's a time to listen to other perspectives: when everyone plays their part, the result is far greater.

Reversed. Reversed, it points to a lack of coordination, friction in the team or tasks done in a rush. It can also reflect little appreciation for your effort, or yours for other people's. Check how you communicate and rediscover the taste for carefully finished details.

♦ *Share your talent and let others add theirs.*



★ FOUR OF PENTACLES

security

control

protection

attachment

letting go

insecurity

imbalance

Upright. A seated man hugs a coin to his chest, stands on two more and balances another on his head, with the city at his back. The Four of Pentacles speaks of the need for security and control. It has a healthy side: protecting what you have achieved, setting boundaries, looking after your energy. But it also has a rigid side: the fear of losing, the difficulty of sharing or letting go. Ask yourself whether what you hold on to gives you peace or whether, without realising it, it has become a cage.

Reversed. Reversed, it can show that you are beginning to loosen your grip and open up to sharing. In other cases it points the opposite way: an insecurity that leads to spending without measure or to clinging on even harder. Find the middle ground between holding and letting flow.

♦ *Be grateful for what you have and open your hands a little so that life can flow.*



★ FIVE OF PENTACLES

lack

exclusion

hardship

help close by

recovery

support

pride that isolates

Upright. Two figures trudge through the snow, poorly wrapped up, beside a lit window they don't seem to see. The Five of Pentacles reflects times of lack, of feeling left out, of sensing that support or stability is missing. It may be a material worry or an inner feeling of scarcity. But the key is in that window: help exists and is closer than you think. This card encourages you to ask for it, to set pride aside and to remember that you don't have to cross the winter alone.

Reversed. Reversed, the difficult stage begins to fall behind. Support appears, you regain confidence and feel part of something again. Sometimes it shows that you still find it hard to accept the help being offered. Open the door: you deserve warmth, shelter and a helping hand.

♦ *Ask for help without shame, because there is always a light on for you.*



☆ SIX OF PENTACLES

generosity

reciprocity

giving and receiving

gratitude

· imbalance

help with strings attached

difficulty receiving

Upright. A merchant holds a set of scales while handing out coins to those kneeling before him. The Six of Pentacles speaks of the flow between giving and receiving: generosity, mutual help and reciprocity. Depending on your moment, you may be the one who offers or the one who receives, and both roles are valuable. The scales remind you that balance matters: giving without measure drains you, and receiving without gratitude impoverishes. This card celebrates the abundance that is shared and that, sooner or later, comes back multiplied.

Reversed. Reversed, the exchange becomes lopsided. Perhaps someone gives with conditions attached, or you give so much that nothing is left for yourself. It can also reflect difficulty accepting help. Check whether your relationships are truly reciprocal and whether you allow yourself to receive.

✦ *Give with an open heart and learn to receive too.*



☆ SEVEN OF PENTACLES

patience

assessment

sustained effort

harvest

· impatience

frustration

misdirected effort

Upright. Leaning on his hoe, a farmer contemplates a plant heavy with coins. He has worked hard and now pauses to look. The Seven of Pentacles speaks of patience, of valuing what you have sown and of understanding that fruit takes its time. It is a pause to ask yourself whether you're on the right track, whether it's worth continuing to tend that crop or whether something should change. Lasting results can't be forced: they ripen when their season comes.

Reversed. Reversed, it reflects impatience or frustration because your effort isn't bearing fruit as quickly as you hoped. It can also show energy poured into something that no longer nourishes you. Review your planting honestly and adjust your course, without blaming yourself for what no longer fits.

✦ *Trust your planting and give it the time it needs to flower.*



EIGHT OF PENTACLES

dedication

learning

mastery

perseverance

perfectionism

lack of motivation

careless work

Upright. Absorbed at his workbench, a craftsman carves one coin after another with the same care. The Eight of Pentacles is the card of craft, practice and constant improvement. It speaks of learning a skill, of refining yourself, of putting your heart into the details. There are no shortcuts here, but there is deep satisfaction in work well done. If you're training or starting something new, this card tells you that every hour of dedication counts and leaves its mark.

Reversed. Reversed, it can point to a perfectionism that paralyses, repetitive tasks that feel meaningless or a lack of motivation. It can also mean work done hastily and without care. Ask yourself whether what you do still excites you or whether you need to renew your purpose in order to enjoy it again.

♦ *Practise with love, because mastery is built day by day.*



NINE OF PENTACLES

self-sufficiency

enjoyment

achievement

comfort

dependence

excess

hollow success

Upright. In a lush garden, surrounded by vines and coins, an elegant woman strolls with a falcon perched on her gloved hand. The Nine of Pentacles celebrates independence and the enjoyment of what you have achieved through your own effort. It is the satisfaction of being at ease with yourself, of savouring beauty, wellbeing and calm. It speaks of self-esteem and of enjoying your own company. You have earned this moment: allow yourself to live it without guilt and with your head held high.

Reversed. Reversed, it suggests that you depend on other people to feel secure, or an enjoyment that tips into excess. It can also speak of an image of success that hides a certain emptiness inside. Return to whatever truly makes you feel at peace.

♦ *Celebrate what you have built and treat yourself to the pleasure of enjoying it.*



TEN OF PENTACLES

legacy

family

roots

lasting stability

family tensions

instability

breaking with tradition

Upright. Beneath an archway, an elderly man pets his dogs while a couple and a child talk nearby; ten coins trace a tree of life over the scene. The Ten of Pentacles speaks of lasting stability, of roots, of family and of legacy. It is what endures over time: traditions, values, a home that welcomes. It represents the fulfilment built through perseverance and shared across generations. It invites you to value your origins and to think about what you want to leave behind.

Reversed. Reversed, it points to family tensions, disagreements over material matters or a sense that what was stable is wobbling. It can also show a wish to break with traditions that no longer suit you. You have the right to build your own legacy.

♦ *Honour your roots and sow today what you want to leave tomorrow.*



PAGE OF PENTACLES

study

practical learning

responsibility

new goals

procrastination

lack of focus

dreams without action

Upright. Standing in a fertile field, a young person gazes in fascination at the coin held up in their hands. The Page of Pentacles represents the start of practical learning, an opportunity that calls for study and perseverance. As a person, this card describes someone studious, responsible and down to earth, who moves forward slowly but steadily. It can also announce news about work or training. Its message is clear: dreams come true when you give them a concrete shape.

Reversed. Reversed, it reflects a lack of concentration, vague goals or a tendency to leave everything until tomorrow. It can also point to someone who dreams a lot but takes few steps. Choose a small, achievable goal, give it a place in your diary and start today.

♦ *Take the first concrete step towards your dream, however small.*



KNIGHT OF PENTACLES

perseverance

reliability

method

patience

stagnation

stubbornness

empty routine

Upright. Mounted on a sturdy horse that stands perfectly still, the Knight of Pentacles studies the coin he holds and the ploughed fields in the distance. He is the slowest of the knights, but also the most reliable. He symbolises perseverance, routine and methodical work that always reaches the finish line. As a person, he is responsible, patient and loyal, someone who keeps their word even if they aren't the most spontaneous. His presence reminds you that perseverance triumphs where haste gives up.

Reversed. Reversed, perseverance turns into stagnation, stubbornness or boredom. It can reflect someone so focused on the practical that they forget to enjoy life, or a routine that no longer adds anything. Introduce a small change that brings back your enthusiasm.

♦ *Move forward step by step and trust the strength of your perseverance.*



★ QUEEN OF PENTACLES

nurturing

abundance

practicality

warmth

self-neglect

overprotectiveness

material worry

Upright. Surrounded by flowers and fruit, with a rabbit at her feet, the Queen of Pentacles holds her coin in her lap with tenderness. She embodies practical care, the abundance of the home and a connection with nature and the body. As a person, she is warm, generous and resourceful, someone who makes others feel safe and knows how to turn a little into enough. This card invites you to look after yourself and those you love, balancing work with your own wellbeing.

Reversed. Reversed, care falls out of balance: you give yourself so fully to others that you forget yourself, or you worry too much about material things. It can also point to neglect of your home or your own needs. Return to your centre and nourish yourself with the same generosity you offer.

♦ *Care for yourself with the same tenderness with which you care for others.*



★ KING OF PENTACLES

success

stability

generosity

solidity

obsession with status

control

complacency

Upright. Dressed in a robe embroidered with grapes, the King of Pentacles sits before a prosperous castle with his coin in hand. He represents success achieved through effort, stability and the ability to make everything he touches grow. As a person, he is reliable, enterprising, protective and generous, someone who enjoys the good life without losing common sense. In your reading, he symbolises the maturity of one who has built solid foundations and knows how to share their abundance with serenity.

Reversed. Reversed, security turns into an obsession with status, stubbornness or a need to control. It can reflect someone who measures the value of everything by material things. It also warns against complacency. Remember that true wealth includes sincere bonds and inner peace.

♦ *Build firmly and share your abundance with generosity.*



How to ask the question

The first step of every good reading

A good reading begins with a good question. The cards answer what you ask, so if the question is muddled, the answer will be too. Learning to ask is, in itself, a way of finding clarity.

♦ OPEN QUESTIONS RATHER THAN CLOSED ONES

"Yes or no" questions limit the tarot a great deal. The cards speak in images and nuances, not in monosyllables. Closed questions also put you in a passive role, as if everything depended on fate. Open questions, on the other hand, give you back your power.

INSTEAD OF...	TRY...
Will they come back to me?	What do I need to understand about this relationship to be at peace?
Will I get the job?	What can I do to show up more strongly in this process?
Is this year going to go well for me?	What energy would it serve me to cultivate this year?
Are they lying to me?	What is my intuition showing me about this situation?
Should I quit my job?	What should I take into account before deciding about my job?

♦ FIVE KEYS TO PHRASING YOUR QUESTION

- 1 **Centre it on yourself.** Ask about what you can do, feel or understand, not about what others will do.
- 2 **Be specific.** "What do I need to know about my online shop project?" works better than "What's going on in my life?"
- 3 **One question at a time.** If you mix several topics, the cards get mixed up too.
- 4 **Write it down.** Noting it forces you to make it precise and will help you review the reading later.
- 5 **Don't repeat the spread.** If you don't like the answer, don't draw cards again until you've reflected on it. Repeating only creates confusion.

✦ WHAT THE TAROT SHOULD NOT ANSWER

There are subjects that are best left out of the cards, out of respect for yourself and for others: health matters and diagnoses, important legal or financial decisions, someone's death, or questions that invade another person's privacy without their permission. For all of that there are professionals, and the tarot can keep you company, but never replace them.



Spreads step by step

From one card to the Celtic Cross

A spread is the way you lay the cards out on the table. Each position has a meaning, and the card that falls there answers that part of the question. Here are three spreads to begin with, from the simplest to the most complete.

♦ 1. THE CARD OF THE DAY



What it's for: to connect with yourself each morning and to learn the meanings little by little.

How to do it: shuffle while thinking "What energy is with me today?" and draw a single card. Read it, write down three words it inspires and, in the evening, note how it showed up in your day.

It is the simplest practice and the most powerful. If you do it every day for a month, you'll have got to know a great many cards in a living way, tied to your own experiences.

♦ 2. THE THREE-CARD SPREAD



What it's for: almost any question. It's the spread you'll use most.

How to do it: draw three cards and lay them from left to right. Decide beforehand what each position means.

You can use different versions depending on your question:

VERSION	CARD 1	CARD 2	CARD 3
Time	Past	Present	Future trend
Situation	Situation	Obstacle	Advice
Decision	Option A	Option B	What you should bear in mind
Relationship	You	The other person	The relationship
Whole self	Mind	Body	Spirit

EXAMPLE READING

Question: "What do I need to know about the project I want to start?" Version: situation, obstacle, advice.

1. Situation: Ace of Wands. There's a new spark, an enormous desire to create. The project is born with plenty of energy.

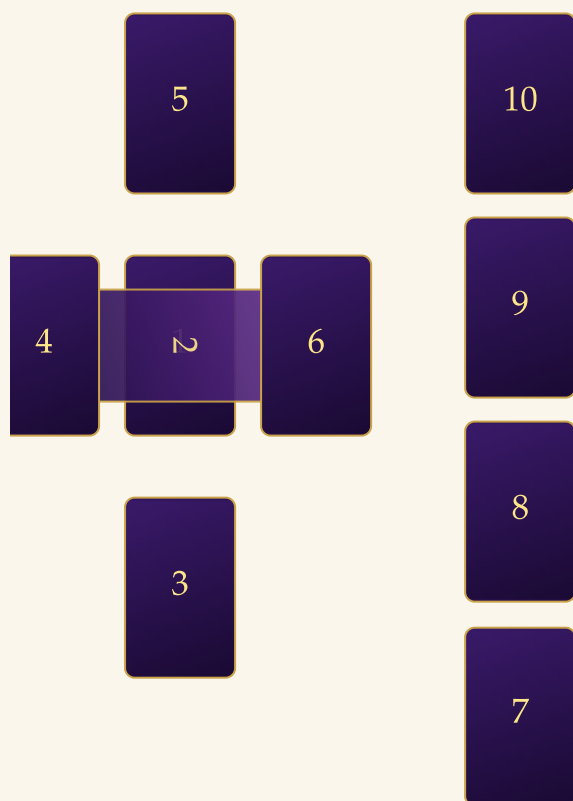
2. Obstacle: Four of Cups. Some listlessness or mistrust: perhaps you're not appreciating the opportunities already in front of you, or you find it hard to commit.

3. Advice: The Magician. You have all the tools. It's time to move from idea to action with what you already know and what you already have.

The story: the energy is there (Ace of Wands) and so are the resources (The Magician). The brake is inside: an apathy that stops you seeing what you have. That the advice is a Major Arcanum shows this step is important. The message: stop waiting for the perfect moment and begin.

♦ 3. THE CELTIC CROSS

This is the classic spread par excellence. With ten cards it offers a very complete view of a situation: what causes it, what blocks it, what you feel, what surrounds you and where it may be heading. Save it for important questions and give yourself time to read it calmly.



1. **The heart of the matter:** the current situation.
2. **The crossing:** what challenges you or stands in the way (placed across card 1).
3. **The root:** the deep origin, what lies beneath.
4. **The recent past:** what is being left behind.
5. **The crown:** what you wish for, or the best that can happen.
6. **The near future:** what is approaching.
7. **You:** your attitude towards the situation.
8. **Your surroundings:** the people and circumstances around you.
9. **Hopes and fears:** what you long for and what you dread, sometimes the same thing.
10. **The outcome:** where everything is heading if nothing changes.

How to read the Celtic Cross without feeling overwhelmed.

Don't try to interpret all ten cards at once. Read them in pairs: 1 and 2 (the central conflict), 3 and 5 (what lies beneath and what you aspire to), 4 and 6 (where you come from and where you're going), 7 and 8 (you and your surroundings). Then look at 9 and finish with 10, always comparing it with 1.



Weaving the cards' message

How to turn single cards into a story

Knowing what each card means is only half the journey. The magic happens when the cards begin to talk to one another and form a story. This is the method I suggest for achieving that, step by step.

- 1 **First impression.** Before thinking about meanings, look at the whole spread for a few seconds. What do you feel? Are there light or dark colours? Movement or stillness? Note that first sensation: your intuition speaks before your memory does.
- 2 **Count the Major Arcana.** If there are many, the situation is deep and has to do with a life process. If almost all are Minor, it is something more everyday and within your hands.
- 3 **Look for the dominant element.** Lots of Wands: action. Lots of Cups: emotions. Lots of Swords: thoughts or conflicts. Lots of Pentacles: the practical. And which suit is missing? Sometimes what doesn't appear is also a message.
- 4 **Notice repeated numbers.** Several Aces speak of beginnings; several Fives, of a moment of crisis and change; several Tens, of a cycle closing.
- 5 **Observe the glances and directions.** The figures are looking somewhere. If a figure looks towards another card, it connects with it; if it turns its back, it may be moving away from that situation.
- 6 **Interpret each card in its position.** Now, at last, read the meaning of each card as applied to what its place in the spread represents.
- 7 **Tell the story.** Join it all into a tale, as if you were narrating a short story: "At first... but... and then...". If the story makes sense to you, you're on the right track.
- 8 **Finish with advice.** Ask yourself: after all this, what can I do? Every reading should end with something concrete that is in your hands.

♦ WHEN A CARD DOESN'T FIT

It will happen to you: a card comes up and you don't understand what it's doing there. Don't force it. Note it down, let the reading rest and look at it again the next day. Often its meaning appears later, when life shows it to you. And if it still doesn't fit, you can draw a clarifying card and place it beside it.

✦ TRUST WHAT YOU SEE

The meanings in this guide are a starting point, not a law. If an image tells you something different at a particular moment, listen to it. With practice, your intuition and your knowledge will go hand in hand, and that is where true readings are born.



Your first month with tarot

A four-week practice plan

Reading the tarot is like playing an instrument: you learn by practising. This four-week plan will help you gain fluency without feeling overwhelmed. All you need is your deck, a notebook that will be your tarot journal and between ten and twenty minutes a day.

WEEK 1 · GETTING TO KNOW THE MAJOR ARCANA

- ★ Each day, study three or four Major Arcana following The Fool's Journey. Look at the image before reading its entry and write down what it suggests to you.
- ★ Draw your card of the day only from among the 22 Major Arcana.
- ★ At the end of the week, put the Major Arcana in order and tell yourself The Fool's Journey out loud in your own words.

WEEK 2 · THE SUITS AND THE NUMBERS

- ★ Dedicate each day to one suit: look at all of it, from the Ace to the Ten, as if it were a little story.
- ★ Play at deducing: draw a minor card, think about what its number and its suit mean, and then check it in the guide.
- ★ Card of the day with the full deck.

WEEK 3 · THE COURT AND THREE-CARD SPREADS

- ★ Separate the 16 court cards. For each one, think of someone you know who resembles it.
- ★ Do one three-card spread a day on simple topics: your day, a conversation you've been putting off, a film you're going to watch.
- ★ Practise telling the story of the three cards out loud.

WEEK 4 · FULL READINGS

- ✦ Do your first Celtic Cross on a question that matters to you. Take your time and read it in pairs.
- ✦ Try the reversed cards, if you feel like it.
- ✦ Offer to do a three-card spread for someone you trust. Explaining the cards to another person is the best way of learning them.

✦ YOUR TAROT JOURNAL

Your journal is your best teacher. Over time you'll see patterns, cards that keep coming back and personal meanings that no book can give you. With every reading, note down:

Date · Moon (if you like)

My question:

Spread I used:

Cards that came up (and their position):

My first impression:

The story they tell me:

What I'm going to do:

A few days later, what happened?

✦ EXERCISES TO FREE THE IMAGINATION

- ✦ **The three-card tale:** draw three cards at random and invent a children's story with them. No meanings, just what you see.
- ✦ **The mirror card:** look through the deck for the card that best describes how you feel today, without shuffling, choosing it deliberately.
- ✦ **The dialogue:** choose a card and write what it would say to you if it could speak. Then answer it.
- ✦ **The pairs:** look in the deck for cards that "converse" with each other, such as The Moon and The Sun or the Two of Cups and the Three of Swords. What do they say to each other?

Quick reference: all 78 cards

The keywords at a glance

♦ MAJOR ARCANA

CARD	UPRIGHT	REVERSED
The Fool	new beginnings, freedom, trust	recklessness, fear of starting
The Magician	willpower, skill, manifestation	manipulation, untapped talent
The High Priestess	intuition, mystery, stillness	disconnection, secrets
The Empress	abundance, creativity, nurturing	self-neglect, creative block
The Emperor	structure, authority, stability	rigidity, control
The Hierophant	tradition, teaching, values	dogmatism, rebellion
The Lovers	love, choice, union	indecision, imbalance
The Chariot	determination, progress, victory	lack of direction, feeling stuck
Strength	courage, compassion, patience	insecurity, impulsiveness
The Hermit	introspection, chosen solitude, searching	isolation, avoidance
Wheel of Fortune	cycles, change, opportunity	resisting change, stagnation
Justice	balance, truth, responsibility	self-deception, imbalance
The Hanged Man	pause, new perspective, surrender	stagnation, resistance
Death	transformation, necessary endings, renewal	resisting change, attachment
Temperance	balance, harmony, moderation	excess, impatience
The Devil	attachments, desire, shadow	release, awareness
The Tower	sudden change, revelation, liberation	fear of change, inner crisis
The Star	hope, healing, inspiration	discouragement, disconnection
The Moon	intuition, dreams, uncertainty	confusion clearing, fears fading
The Sun	joy, success, vitality	dimmed joy, overoptimism
Judgement	awakening, inner calling, rebirth	self-criticism, doubt

The World	fulfilment, achievement, integration	unfinished cycle, lack of closure
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✦ WANDS

CARD	UPRIGHT	REVERSED
Ace of Wands	inspiration, new beginnings, creative spark	feeling blocked, delays
Two of Wands	planning, vision, decision	fear of the unknown, indecision
Three of Wands	expansion, perspective, progress	obstacles, impatience
Four of Wands	celebration, home, harmony	tension at home, instability
Five of Wands	competition, conflict, clashing opinions	avoiding conflict, inner tension
Six of Wands	victory, recognition, confidence	insecurity, lack of recognition
Seven of Wands	standing your ground, perseverance, conviction	exhaustion, giving up
Eight of Wands	speed, movement, news	delays, haste
Nine of Wands	resilience, persistence, caution	exhaustion, mistrust
Ten of Wands	burden, responsibility, overwork	putting the weight down, delegating
Page of Wands	enthusiasm, curiosity, exploration	lack of direction, immaturity
Knight of Wands	boldness, adventure, passion	impulsiveness, recklessness
Queen of Wands	confidence, charisma, warmth	insecurity, jealousy
King of Wands	leadership, vision, entrepreneurship	domineering, impatience

✦ CUPS

CARD	UPRIGHT	REVERSED
Ace of Cups	new love, emotional openness, intuition	emotional block, emptiness
Two of Cups	union, reciprocity, connection	imbalance, drifting apart
Three of Cups	friendship, celebration, community	overindulgence, isolation
Four of Cups	apathy, introspection, dissatisfaction	awakening, renewed motivation
Five of Cups	loss, disappointment, grief	acceptance, healing
Six of Cups	nostalgia, childhood, innocence	stuck in the past, idealising
Seven of Cups	illusions, options, imagination	clarity, decision
Eight of Cups	walking away, searching, detachment	fear of leaving, stagnation
Nine of Cups	contentment, wish fulfilled, gratitude	dissatisfaction, overindulgence

Ten of Cups	family harmony, happiness, emotional fulfilment	disconnection, idealised expectations
Page of Cups	sensitivity, emotional surprise, creativity	emotional immaturity, touchiness
Knight of Cups	romance, idealism, offers	empty promises, mood swings
Queen of Cups	empathy, intuition, compassion	emotional dependency, blurred boundaries
King of Cups	emotional balance, wisdom, diplomacy	bottled-up emotions, manipulation

♦ SWORDS

CARD	UPRIGHT	REVERSED
Ace of Swords	clarity, truth, lucidity	confusion, hurtful words
Two of Swords	indecision, truce, stalemate	pressure, overload
Three of Swords	sorrow, heartbreak, painful truth	healing, forgiveness
Four of Swords	rest, pause, recovery	exhaustion, restlessness
Five of Swords	conflict, pride, hollow victory	reconciliation, lingering resentment
Six of Swords	transition, leaving behind, journey	resistance to change, delays
Seven of Swords	strategy, cunning, discretion	honesty, confession
Eight of Swords	mental block, fear, feeling trapped	liberation, new perspectives
Nine of Swords	worry, anxiety, night-time thoughts	relief, hope
Ten of Swords	end of a cycle, hitting bottom, surrender	recovery, resistance to letting go
Page of Swords	curiosity, vigilance, new ideas	gossip, haste
Knight of Swords	determination, speed, frankness	impulsiveness, verbal aggression
Queen of Swords	lucidity, independence, honesty	coldness, sharp criticism
King of Swords	authority, reason, justice	manipulation, rigidity

♦ PENTACLES

CARD	UPRIGHT	REVERSED
Ace of Pentacles	opportunity, prosperity, new beginning	missed opportunity, insecurity
Two of Pentacles	balance, adaptability, flexibility	disorganisation, overload
Three of Pentacles	collaboration, craft, recognition	lack of coordination, lack of care
Four of Pentacles	security, control, protection	letting go, insecurity
Five of Pentacles	lack, exclusion, hardship	recovery, support

Six of Pentacles	generosity, reciprocity, giving and receiving	imbalance, help with strings attached
Seven of Pentacles	patience, assessment, sustained effort	impatience, frustration
Eight of Pentacles	dedication, learning, mastery	perfectionism, lack of motivation
Nine of Pentacles	self-sufficiency, enjoyment, achievement	dependence, excess
Ten of Pentacles	legacy, family, roots	family tensions, instability
Page of Pentacles	study, practical learning, responsibility	procrastination, lack of focus
Knight of Pentacles	perseverance, reliability, method	stagnation, stubbornness
Queen of Pentacles	nurturing, abundance, practicality	self-neglect, overprotectiveness
King of Pentacles	success, stability, generosity	obsession with status, control



Farewell

Your journey is just beginning

You've reached the end of this guide, but your path with the tarot has only just begun.

At first you'll consult these pages often, and that's perfectly fine. Little by little you'll realise you no longer need to look at them: the cards will begin to speak to you directly, with their images and with your own inner voice.

There will be days when a reading lights your way and days when nothing seems to fit. Both are part of learning. Be patient with yourself, just as you would be with a friend starting something new.

And never forget the most important thing: the tarot is a mirror, not a sentence. It shows you possibilities, invites you to look more deeply, reminds you of what you already know. But the power to decide, to change and to create your life is always in your hands.

Thank you for letting me accompany you at this beginning. Whenever you like, I'll be waiting for you at **taraoraculo.com** so we can keep exploring together.

May the cards light your way,

Tara